

**How Perceptions of Organizational Politics Influence Employee Outcomes:
A Moderated Mediation Model of Workplace Ostracism and Hostile
Attribution Bias**



**HAFIZA HUMA TARIQ
MPHIL THESIS**

**QUAID-I-AZAM SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT SCIENCES
QUAID-I-AZAM UNIVERSITY
ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN
SEPTEMBER, 2022**

**How Perceptions of Organizational Politics Influence Employee Outcomes:
A Moderated Mediation Model of Workplace Ostracism and Hostile
Attribution Bias**

Hafiza Huma Tariq
02152013013



Supervisor
Dr. Rabia Mushtaq
Assistant Professor, QASMS
Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad

**Thesis Submitted in Partial Fulfilment of The Requirements for The Degree of Master of
Philosophy in Management Sciences**

Quaid-I-Azam School of Management Sciences

Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad, Pakistan

September, 2022

Certificate

This is to certify that the thesis submitted by “**Hafiza Huma Tariq**” is accepted in its present form by the School of Management Sciences, Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad, as satisfying the necessary requirements for partial fulfillment of the degree of Master of Philosophy in Management Sciences.

Supervisor

External Examiner

Director

Quaid-I-Azam School of Management Sciences
Quaid-I-Azam University, Islamabad
Original Literary Work Declaration

Name of the Candidate: Hafiza Huma Tariq

Registration No: 02152013013

Name of the Degree: Master of Philosophy

Field of Study: Management Sciences

Title of Thesis (This Work): “How Perceptions of Organizational Politics Influence Employee Outcomes: A Moderated Mediation Model of Workplace Ostracism and Hostile Attribution Bias”

I do solemnly declare that

- 1) I am the soul author of this work.
- 2) This work is original.
- 3) Any use of any work in which copyright exists was done by the way of fair dealing and for permitted purposes and any extracts from, or reference to or reproduction of any copyright work has been disclosed expressly and sufficiently and the title of the work and its authorship have been acknowledged in this work.

Candidate Signature

Date

Solemnly declared before,

Witness's Signature

Date

Name:

Designation:

Dedication

This dissertation is dedicated to my beloved father Tariq Mehmood (late), who always inspired me to get higher education.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

First of all, I want to express my gratitude to Almighty Allah, the Most Gracious and the Most Merciful, for His immense blessings throughout my life and particularly in the journey of my research work, without it I would have never been able to complete this project.

I also want to present a very special thanks to my humble, able and diligent supervisor, Dr. Rabia Mushtaq, who efficiently and thoroughly guided me in my research work. Her guidance and advices enabled me to work under exceptionally challenging circumstances and inspirational me to get rid of any difficulties throughout the study.

In addition, I'd like to express my kind gratitude to my family, especially my beloved mother and elder sister for their motivation, prayers and for providing me with every possible and best opportunity to achieve my goals.

Hafiza Huma Tariq

TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION	1
1.1 Chapter Overview	1
1.2 Background of the Study	1
1.3 Research Gaps.....	7
1.4 Problem Statement	8
1.6 Research Objectives.....	10
1.7 Significance of the Study	10
1.9 Study Plan	13
1.10 Chapter Summary	14
CHAPTER 2	15
LITERATURE REVIEW	15
2.1 Chapter Overview	15
2.2 Perceptions of Organizational Politics.....	15
2.3 Counterproductive Work Behavior.....	18
2.4 Turnover Intention	20
2.5 Workplace Ostracism.....	21
2.6 Hostile Attribution Bias	23
2.7 Underpinning theory	25
2.7.1 Social Exchange Theory	25
2.8 POP and Employee Outcomes	27
2.9 POP and Workplace Ostracism.....	30
2.10 Mediating role of Workplace Ostracism.....	31
2.11 Moderating Role of Hostile Attribution Bias.....	34
2.12 Theoretical Framework.....	38
CHAPTER 3	39
RESEARCH METHODOLOGY.....	39
3.1 Chapter Overview	39
3.2 Research Philosophy	39
3.3 Research Design.....	40
3.4 Population of the Study.....	42

3.5 Unit of Analysis	42
3.7.2 Counterproductive Work Behavior	44
3.7.3 Workplace Ostracism	45
3.7.4 Turnover Intention	45
3.7.5 Hostile Attribution Bias	45
3.8 Control Variables	45
3.9 Statistical Software and Techniques	46
3.10 Ethical Consideration	46
3.11 Chapter Summary	47
CHAPTER 4	48
DATA ANALYSIS AND RESULTS	48
4.1 Chapter Overview	48
4.2 Demographics of Respondents	48
4.2.1 Gender	49
4.2.2 Age	49
4.2.3 Experience	49
4.2.4 Income	50
4.3 Descriptive Statistics	51
4.4 Evaluation of the Measurement Model	52
4.4.1 Internal Consistency Reliability	53
4.4.2 Convergent Validity	53
4.3.3 Item Loadings	54
4.4.5 Discriminant Validity	58
4.4.6 Multicollinearity of the data	61
4.5 Quality of the Structural Model	63
4.5.1 Coefficient of Determination	63
4.5.2 Effect Size	63
4.5.3 Predictive relevance	64
4.5.4 Goodness of Fit	65
4.6 Measurement of the Structural Model	66
4.6.1 Direct Relationships	67
4.6.2 Mediation Testing	69
4.6.3 Moderated Mediation	71

4.7 Chapter Summary	78
CHAPTER 5	79
DISCUSSION, FUTURE RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION.....	79
5.1 Chapter Overview	79
5.2 Interpretation of Direct Paths	79
5.3 Interpretation of Mediating Results	82
5.4 Interpretation of Moderating Results	83
5.4.1 Conditional Direct effects	83
5.4.2 Conditional Indirect effects.....	84
5.5 Theoretical Implications	85
5.6 Managerial Implications	86
5.7 Limitations of the study	87
5.8 Future Directions	89
5.9 Conclusion	90
REFERENCES	92
APPENDIX B	117

LIST OF TABLES

Table 1 - Demographic Information.....	50
Table 2 - Descriptive statistics.....	52
Table 3 - Cronbach's alpha, CR, AVE.....	54
Table 4 - Item Loadings for CWB.....	55
Table 5 – Item loadings for Hostile Attribution Bias.....	56
Table 6 – Item Loadings for POP.....	57
Table 7 – Item Loadings for Turnover Intention.....	57
Table 8 – Item Loadings for Workplace Ostracism.....	58
Table 9 – Formell Lacker.....	60
Table 10 – HTMT.....	61
Table 11 – VIF.....	62
Table 12- Values of R^2 f^2 q^2	65
Table 13- Model Fit.....	66
Table 14 – Direct Paths.....	69
Table 15 – Indirect effects and Total effects.....	71
Table 16 – Interaction term results.....	73
Table 17 - Conditional indirect effects (POP -> WO –CWB).....	75
Table 18- Conditional indirect effects (POP -> WO ->TI).....	76

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure 2.1- Theoretical Framework.....	38
Figure 4.1- Conditional indirect effects (POP -> WO ->CWB).....	77
Figure 4.2- Conditional indirect effects (POP -> WO ->TI).....	77

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

POP	Perceptions of Organizational Politics
WO	Workplace Ostracism
CWB	Counterproductive Work Behavior
TI	Turnover Intention
HAB	Hostile Attribution Bias
CR	Composite Reliability
AVE	Average variance Extracted
PLS_SEM	Partial Least Square-Structural Equation Modeling
VIF	Variance Inflation factor
CR	Composite Reliability
HTMT	Hetrotrait-Monotrait Ratio
Gof	Goodness of Fit
F ²	Effect Size
R ²	Coefficient of Determination
Q ²	Predictive Relevance

ABSTRACT

The purpose of this study was to examine the influence of employee perceptions regarding the political environment of their organization on workplace outcomes (turnover intention, counterproductive work behavior) through a moderated mediation model based on a detailed literature review. The study maintains that workplace ostracism mediates the relationship between perceptions of organizational politics and employee work outcomes. Hostile attribution bias as the proposed moderator of the study, examines the conditional direct and indirect effects between workplace ostracism and employee outcomes relationship and perceptions of organizational politics and employee outcomes relationship respectively. Data was collected from 320 individuals working in different private sector organizations of Pakistan, through convenience sampling technique. Social exchange theory serves as the overarching theory support for the proposed structural model. Perceptions of organizational politics were found to have a positive and significant relationship with turnover intention and counterproductive work behavior. The mediating role of workplace ostracism between the relationship of perceptions of organizational politics and employee outcomes was found positively significant by the results. The results of the moderation revealed that employees with high hostile attribution bias lower their intention to leave the organization when confronted with negative workplace environment instead they engage more in counterproductive work behaviors.

Keywords- Perceptions of Organizational Politics, Hostile Attribution Bias, Workplace Ostracism, Employee Outcomes, Social Exchange Theory

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Chapter Overview

This chapter gives an overview of the current study. Starting with the background of the study, the chapter goes on with explaining the research gap, purpose of study and stating research questions and objectives it ends with presenting the significance and scope of the study.

1.2 Background of the Study

In the era of intense competition and globalization, organizations are striving harder to sustain and progress. Therefore, organizations must value their employees and consider them as the core asset. Employees are the human capital of any organization that makes other resources useful and valuable. Employee outcomes in the workplace are influenced by both their personal attributes and the environment in which they work.

The most important reason for organizations to manage their employee outcomes is the fact that employee attitude and behaviors are crucial factors in determining the growth and development of any organization. Every year organizations bear huge costs due to counterproductive work behaviors (CWB) of their employees. CWB are defined as intentional violation acts of individuals aimed at harming the interest of other individuals or the interests of their organization as a whole (Spector et al., 2006). Literature in the past has highlighted the importance of studying CWB in the workplace due to their negative consequences. CWB has become a source of employee work stress and task uncertainty, it also affects the interpersonal relationship through disagreement and clashes with other co-workers and even with supervisors (P. Y. Chen & Spector, 1992). Based on various targets of CWB, it is conceptually divided into two sub dimensions; CWB directed towards individuals (CWB-I) and CWB directed towards

organization (CWB-O), discussed by various researchers in the literature. Prevalence of CWB may result in employees' low productivity, increased absenteeism and intentions to quit that are harmful for the financial state of any organization.

Another important issue for organizations worldwide in today's highly competitive environment is to retain qualified and efficient personnel. In literature turnover intention is defined as employee intentional plans and efforts to depart from their organization (Carmeli & Weisberg, 2006). Employee turnover intention may result in actual turnover. However, actual turnover is distinct from turnover intention as the latter is defined as employee attitude towards its organization (Ngo-Henha, 2018). Thus, organizations need to carefully handle this situation, as employee turnover badly affects the organizations; it may have a significant impact on businesses, both directly and indirectly, resulting in higher hiring and training costs, reduced profitability, lower levels of productivity, bringing down overall employee morale and significantly impact employee performance (Hayward, Bungay, Wolff, & MacDonald, 2016). Moreover, turnover intentions reduce employee work engagement and hamper their citizenship behavior (Xiong & Wen, 2020). As the literature has stated several negative consequences of turnover intentions and CWB, it has become more crucial to identify the process through which employees develop such attitudes and initiate devastating behaviors at work.

Politics is an evident facet of organizational life. Organizational politics is defined as a process that influences social mechanisms in an organization, in which an individual is motivated to secure his own interests at the cost of others' interest in the organization (Miller, Rutherford, & Kolodinsky, 2008). Moreover, employees might choose ways not sanctioned by their organization to pursue their goals (G. Ferris, Adams, Kolodinsky, Hochwarter, & Ammeter, 2002) and against the goals of the overall organization. For understanding the pervasive impact

of ongoing political activities in an organization, it requires determining how employees' perceptions of organizational politics (POP) influence their attitudinal and behavioral responses in the workplace. Thus, the current study's focus is on employee's interpretation about their organizational political climate. The idea of POP has started evolving mainly in the last three decades, after being presented as employees' subjective assessments regarding the political climate of their organization. Employee perceptions may or may not depict the actual reality, they are characterized with uncertainty and ambiguity which create stressful situations, making it more difficult for employees to comprehend and operate in certain circumstances (Hochwarter et al., 2020).

POP has been found to have adverse consequences for both individuals and the organization. At individual level literature has discussed several undesirable work outcomes as the consequence of POP such as job burnout, intentions to quit, job dissatisfaction (Miller et al., 2008) and reduced work performance (C. Chang, Rosen, & Levy, 2009). Organizational politics' negative implications not only impede individual growth, but they also have negative consequences at the organizational level, since it has been empirically tested that organizational politics is a threat to overall organizational success (Iqbal, 2021). POP is discussed as a stressful event in organizations for employees which lead them to develop intentions to leave their jobs (Ali, Zhang, & Aman, 2021). Another reason for employee intentions to quit is their response to the political games played by other coworkers in order to satisfy their self-serving behaviors. On awareness of the high political atmosphere some employees might refuse to accept the ways adopted by others, reducing their social acceptance of self-serving behaviors of others might lead them to think of quitting their current jobs (Clercq, Khan, & Haq, 2021). POP plays a pivotal role in lowering employees' morale; as a result employees reduce making efforts toward their

work. It not only evokes but also exacerbates negative emotions in employees such as hostility, which becomes a determinant factor of arousing deviant behaviors among employees (Meisler, Drory, & Vigoda-Gadot, 2019). Employees, who perceive the political climate in the workplace, find others' self-serving behavior as an opportunity to indulge in counterproductive work behaviors. Findings from a previous study revealed that as a response to POP, employees reduce their discretionary behavior towards their organization, coworkers and even their customers by practicing counterproductive behaviors such as knowledge hiding (Kaur & Kang, 2022).

Individuals spend an ample time of their day at their workplaces where they work together and develop interpersonal relationships. As interpersonal interactions are a must in organizations for employees to discuss ideas, make better decisions, to appreciate and motivate each other's work and work together for shared organizational goals. The strength of interpersonal relations at work can well determine organizational effectiveness. However, as a matter of fact interpersonal relationships at work are not always smooth and hindered by the prevalence of interpersonal stressors. Organizations today face a diverse range of problems; one prominent of them is to deal with the interpersonal stressors. Research in the field of interpersonal stressors has discussed various facets such as workplace bullying, workplace incivility and workplace ostracism having a prominent impact on overall organization. Out of these interpersonal stressors, the current study's focus is workplace ostracism. This phenomenon has gained considerable attention in the workplaces having damaging effects for both individuals and the organization. However, after it is presented more accurately together with a validated scale, workplace ostracism got massive attention in the literature (D. L. Ferris, Brown, Berry, & Lian, 2008).

Ostracism in the literature is explained through different ways it can be punitive as defined by the study of (K. D. Williams, 1997), in which ostracized employees are shunned or given silent treatment due to the assumption of teaching them a lesson about their misbehaving or maintaining the discipline and cohesiveness of the group and making out an example of them so the other group members can compare themselves. Ostracism can also be casual or ambiguous where the ostracized employees have no idea why they are ignored by their friends, family or colleagues. Moreover, the initiator of ostracism might also be unaware of his acts of ignoring others (Robinson, O'Reilly, & Wang, 2013). Ostracism which is ambiguous is more damaging for an individual's self-esteem as they are more conscious about their behaviors as they perceive that they might have done something wrong.

Covering a wide range of social settings, workplace ostracism has empirically tested for having a negative impact on employee's attitudes and behaviors (Bedi, 2021). Ostracized employees might feel increased level of stress, feelings of depression and loneliness than their coworkers. Furthermore, it is found to be a cause of decrease in employee discretionary efforts in the workplace (Chung, 2017). Ostracized employees might feel adverse effects on their physical and psychological health (Choi, 2019). Moreover, employees might think of leaving their organization and searching for alternative jobs (Singh & Srivastava, 2021). The harmful effects of ostracism lead an employee towards social isolation resulting in reduced self-esteem and self-control (K. D. Williams, 2009). Moreover, socially excluded employees develop feelings of frustration and with reduced self-control they are more prone towards engaging in aggressive attitudes and behaviors (Yan, Zhou, Long, & Ji, 2014). Employees who stay in the organization confronting ostracism, potentially get involved in various negative behaviors such as deviant

behavior (Jahanzeb & Fatima, 2018), unsafe behavior (Y. Chen & Li, 2020) and counterproductive work behaviors (Yang & Treadway, 2018).

Literature on workplace ostracism is still growing, although researchers have taken a good effort in exploring its consequences, the area of related antecedents still needs more exploration (Adams & John, 1997). In the light of previous research studies on POP, it is evident that employees who perceive a higher level of politics in the workplace are more likely to experience detrimental outcomes. Accordingly, the current study assumes that POP might be positively associated with interpersonal stressors such as workplace ostracism.

Furthermore, the current study investigates the conditional effects under which the direct relationship between POP and employee outcomes which are turnover intention and CWB and indirect relationship of POP with employee outcomes through workplace ostracism would be effective. Not every individual perceives the interpersonal situations at the same level in the organization, some have the tendency to blame others for every benign or ambiguous situation that they are not able to comprehend, and such individuals have biases to attribute every action of others as negative or hostile. Hostile attribution bias is one of the attribution biases that may well define the individual differences in attributing others behaviors and situations (Adams & John, 1997). An individuals' hostile attribution bias may exacerbate the negative effects of interpersonal stressors on various workplace outcomes. It has proven to be damaging for individuals' health by increasing their emotional exhaustion at work. POP plays a pivotal role in developing certain interpersonal stressors in the workplace due to its self-serving mechanisms through which employees may ignore (D. N. Karim, Abdul Majid, Omar, & Aburumman, 2021) or treat others members in an uncivil manner (Ogunbamila, 2013) . However it's not always the situational factors but some certain individual characteristics or differences that can aid in

creating or exacerbating the tension among the interpersonal relationships and bring negative consequences for organization (Rosen & Hochwarter, 2014; Zhao, Xia, He, Sheard, & Wan, 2016). To check the level of individual differences that can affect the delirious impact of POP and workplace ostracism on employee outcomes, hostile attribution bias serves as an important boundary condition in the current study.

1.3 Research Gaps

1. Unfair tactics, unequal reward distributions and favoritism are common features of a politically oriented workplace. Thus, employees who perceive organizational politics may face numerous undesired outcomes, reduced commitment towards organization, stress, dissatisfaction at the workplace, high levels of burnout, lowered job performance and turnover intentions (Landells & Albrecht, 2017; Saleem, 2015). However, there are inconclusive results on negative outcomes of POP (C. Chang et al., 2009; Miller et al., 2008), thus the current study aims to fill this gap with empirically testing the association between POP and negative employee outcomes such as CWB and turnover intention.

2. Political work climate develops negative feelings among employees that leads towards interpersonal distrust and interpersonal conflicts (D. N. Karim et al., 2021; Rosen & Hochwarter, 2014; Saleem, 2015) and has devastating consequences for the exchange relationship which increases the likelihood of employees experiencing negative interaction (X. Zhang & Dai, 2015) and may result in workplace ostracism. As suggested by (Li, Xu, & Kwan, 2021) the literature needs to identify more antecedents that can potentially predict workplace ostracism, thus to fill this gap the present study aims to test the positive association of POP with workplace ostracism.

3. The current study also addresses the gap in the area of less explored underlying mechanisms that can better explain association between POP with negative employee outcomes. Thus, the current study aims to explore the mediating role of workplace ostracism for the first time in the literature of POP.

4. The literature has established a link between perceptions of organizational politics and workplace ostracism, however only two studies tested the association in higher education settings, empirical testing in other work settings is still less explored (D. Karim, 2021; D. N. Karim et al., 2021). To fill this gap, the current study aims to test the empirical association between POP and workplace ostracism in other work settings specific to the private sector of Pakistan.

5. Moreover, very few studies have discussed the role of individual differences as a potential boundary condition in the literature of POP. As suggested by the previous research studies the current study aims to test the buffering role of hostile attribution bias as individual differences in attribution styles, adding valuable insights in the current literature of POP workplace ostracism and employees' negative outcomes (C.-H. Chang, Rosen, Siemienieć, & Johnson, 2012).

1.4 Problem Statement

The prevalence of organizational climate may hamper the employees to function at their full potential in the workplace. Moreover, organizations may also face the burden of negative employee outcomes. Various researchers have highlighted the damaging effects of employee turnover intention for the organization (Farasat, Afzal, Jabeen, Farhan, & Sattar, 2021). Turnover intention leads an employee to actually leaving the organization in most of the cases. As employee turnover causes an organization to not only lose a competent employee, it also costs

the organization as organizations spend on recruitment, selection and training of their employees. Moreover, the workplace environment has a detrimental effect on employee outcomes, as results from previous studies revealed higher turnover rate in the private sector of Pakistan (Bajwa, Yousaf, & Rizwan, 2014). Additionally, as employers globally seek ways to curtail the frequency of CWB in organizations, developing countries are also at the same pace. Recent studies have also highlighted the importance of studying CWB as a consequence of employee perception of organizational climate (Meisler et al., 2019).

Many studies have been conducted to highlight issues and problems prevailing in the workplace environment. However, less empirical studies are available on POP and its negative consequences via workplace ostracism in the private sector of Pakistan. Thus, the present study will unfold and empirically investigate the relationship between POP, CWB and employee turnover intention. Furthermore, individual differences in attributing others behavior and situations can intensify the occurrence of negative workplace outcomes, thus it's crucial to investigate the role of hostile attribution bias in relation with POP and employee outcomes.

1.5 Research Questions

Based on problems stated above, the current study has summarized the following research questions:

- Question 1: Does POP influences employees' turnover intention and CWB in the private sector?
- Question 2: Does workplace ostracism mediate the relationship between POP and employee outcomes (i.e. turnover intention and CWB)?
- Question 3: Does workplace ostracism affects employees' turnover intention and CWB in the private sector?

- Question 4: Does employee hostile attribution bias moderates the direct relationship between workplace ostracism and employee outcomes (i.e. turnover intention and CWB) and indirect relationship between POP and employee outcomes (i.e. turnover intention and CWB) through workplace ostracism?

1.6 Research Objectives

The present study intends to develop and evaluate an anticipated research model to find out the association between POP, workplace ostracism, CWB and turnover intention of employees in the private sector. In addition, employee hostile attribution bias is added as the potential moderator to check the association between the stated relationships. In the light of research questions discussed above the current research has developed following research objectives:

1. To understand and empirically test the association between POP and employee outcomes (CWB and turnover intention).
2. To check the mediation effect of workplace ostracism between POP and employee outcomes (CWB and turnover intention).
3. To empirically test the impact of workplace ostracism on and employee outcomes (CWB and turnover intention).
4. To investigate the impact of hostile attribution bias as moderator in association between workplace ostracism and employee outcomes (CWB and turnover intention) and on the indirect effect between POP and employee outcomes (CWB and turnover intention).

1.7 Significance of the Study

The current study provides help to the organizations to understand why and how their employees get involved in negative workplace outcomes. Not only this, the study explains the whole mechanism through which employees in an organization are motivated to engage in

counterproductive behaviors and develop intentions to leave their organization. Extending the views presented in previous studies, the present study emphasizes the prevalence of perceptual climate in the organization. Employee perceptions are crucial to understand in the organizational context as they exert substantial influence on the work outcomes.

This study also presents a holistic view for the understanding of organizations to understand how employee behaviors and attitudes are shaped in the workplace. Employees face various kinds of interpersonal stressors in the workplace, for instance workplace ostracism. Ostracized employees might report decreased organizational commitment, organizational identification and job satisfaction (Li et al., 2021). Moreover, employee behaviors such as voice behavior, discretionary behaviors and in-role behavior are inversely affected by the ostracizing behaviors of other employees (Chung & Yang, 2017).

Furthermore, the study explored the link between employee perceptions of organizational climate and workplace ostracism to enhance the understanding of negative employee outcomes. Employees' feelings of interpersonal distrust and conflict may raise the possibility of workplace negative interactions in the shape of workplace ostracism, which might be the potential consequence of POP. Workplace ostracism serves as the mediator in this study which will have significant contributions for both the practical and theoretical perspectives in the literature.

This study also provides significant contributions in the literature of POP by introducing hostile attribution bias as the potential moderator. As Individual differences play a pivotal role in shaping employee perceptions, it has become important for organizations to detect employees with hostile personality characteristics. This study sheds light on individual characteristics that might influence employee perceptions, behaviors and attitudes in the workplace.

Lastly, the present study is significant for the private sector organizations in Pakistan, as to the best knowledge of researchers of the current study no prior research has been undertaken so far to investigate the association between workplace ostracism and POP in this context.

1.8 Context and Scope of the study

Overall, the research on the link between POP and employee negative workplace outcomes leads one to assume that employee perceptions are of important concern for organizations. Generally, organizations consist and made up of diverse range of activities, they also differ from one another in terms of the nature of their business and scale. Findings of one study are not applicable to all industries given that they are different in terms of organizational and national cultures, working conditions, organizational structure, and regulations and policies.

Therefore, findings of earlier research investigations done in the western region settings cannot be applied to the situations of the eastern region. Most of the research on political perceptions has been conducted in western regions, where the characteristics of the workplace differ from those of the south Asian region. Individuals working in Pakistani organizations may experience distinct effects depending on how POP and workplace ostracism is perceived.

Based on the discussion above, the current study has much relevance with the Pakistani context. Very few researchers have conducted research studies on POP in accordance with the culture of Pakistan. It is very crucial to understand the cultural difference between Western and East Asian countries. One difference is clearly stated by the past researchers as individualist and collectivist cultures (Triandis, 1996). According to the meta-analysis presented by Oh et al., (2014) on differences between cultural contexts of North America and East Asia, the latter is more centered on associating interpersonal relations with work outcomes.

1.9 Study Plan

The current Chapter 1 presents a brief introduction of all study variables and background that includes the defining research gaps, problem statement, research questions and research objectives based on the issues identified, the scope of the research, and significance of the study all these elements together provide an overview for the present study.

Chapter 2 highlights the literature review for all study variables. Five variables are used in the present study as independent variable, dependent variable, mediating variable and the moderating variable. After that research defines the underpinning theory for the current study that holds the base for conceptual framework. Furthermore, 11 hypotheses are developed based on gaps identified in the literature review.

Next, Chapter 3 defines the strategy and methods through which the hypothesis will be tested. In simple words it is the strategy for carrying out the research. It includes discussion on the research philosophy, research design, sampling strategy and data collection methods, use of the already validated instruments from the available literature. Lastly, it discusses the use of statistical software's through which hypotheses of the current study will be tested and analyzed.

Chapter 4 mainly discusses the data analysis and testing of various hypotheses, based on the conceptual framework of the study. The chapter further discusses significance and non-significance of results that provides a decision for acceptance or rejection of the hypotheses.

Final chapter 5 discusses the results obtained in chapter 4 and relates them to the research questions and objectives of the study. Moreover, it provides theoretical and managerial implications of the study, discusses the limitations of study and provides future directions on the bases of issues defined in the current study. Lastly, it concludes the study by providing a summary of the complete dissertation.

1.10 Chapter Summary

This chapter gives brief introduction of the study variables i.e. POP, workplace ostracism, CWB, turnover intention and hostile attribution bias. After that it provides a link between all study variables and narrows down the discussion by providing research gaps of the study. Furthermore, a statement of problem is discussed which forms the base for research objectives and research questions of the study. Lastly, it briefly discusses the organization of the dissertation that helps the reader in taking an overview of all chapters of the present study.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Chapter Overview

The aim of this chapter is to thoroughly evaluate the prior literature in order to identify the link among study variables and establish the relationships between them that are crucial for this research. This chapter further presents a comprehensive analysis of the variables used in this study's conceptual framework. Previous research findings on the relationships between constructs are presented for empirical support to support the building of the hypothesis for this study.

2.2 Perceptions of Organizational Politics

Organizational politics is the reality of today's world and no organization is spared from the prevalence of political activities or perceptions of politics. In literature organizational politics is defined as a social influence process used by individuals for their self-interest and comfort at the cost of others and the organization (Burns, 1961). Other researchers have taken a similar approach to define organizational politics as human behavior strategically designed to acquire short-term or long term goals without considering the goals and interest of the organization and its members (Gotsis & Kortezi, 2011; Miller et al., 2008). However, various approaches have been widely used in understanding and evolving the organizational politics' construct. Research on political behavior as employee influence tactics is the first approach and has advanced the research on organizational politics (Vigoda, 2002). It has further been presented as persistent influence strategies used by employees, either individually or collectively, with the sole purpose

of pursuing both individual and group interests. In doing so, employees take active part in political activities at their workplace to gain such self-serving goals (Buchanan, 2008).

Researchers have actively investigated the various tactics to influence and their antecedents and consequences are also studied (Burns, 1961; Kipnis, Schmidt, & Wilkinson, 1980). The use of power is also discussed in gaining political pursuits and to influence others in a politically charged environment (Cheng, 1983). Additionally, power moves are carried out by complex tactics to accomplish personal goals within the system of organization (Buchanan, 2008). Second most crucial approach is employee perceptions of their organizational political environment. The phenomenon is defined as the way employees express their views regarding how they perceive their organizational environment, which promotes self-interest and is characterized as unjust and unfair according to employee's perceptions (Kacmar & Ferris, 1991). Although it's necessary to understand that political behavior might be exercised at individual, group or organizational level (Fedor & Maslyn, 2002), employee perceptions are built and observed at the individual level. Another important approach to consider is the use of employee political skills to understand organizational politics and use better tactics to influence others (Kolodinsky, Treadway, & Ferris, 2007). However, the current study focuses on employee perceptions of organizational politics. POP refers to an employee's comprehension of deceptive behaviors at the workplace that permits some employees to further their ambitions at the expense of the interests and well-being of other employees as well as the objectives of the organization (Drory & Vigoda-Gadot, 2010) . As previous studies have concentrated more on the political perceptions in the organizations, the last two decades have seen a huge surge in empirical testing of the phenomenon. The importance of research on political perceptions can clearly be seen from its determinant effects on the work outcomes in the organization (Vigoda, 2002). Political

activities in an organization may develop employee perceptions of their organizational climate. Political climate is characterized by unfair reward distribution, not giving due credit to deserving employees, powerful influence tactics and deceiving employees (Rosen & Levy, 2013). At the upper levels of organizational hierarchy there is more prevalence of political activities and the perceptions are more evident at the lower levels (G. R. Ferris & Kacmar, 1992). POP refers to employees' subjective assessment of self-serving behavior and intent of others in the organization (Cho & Yang, 2018). It further encompasses three categories that are named as general political behavior, go along to go ahead and pay and promotion. First, general political behavior refers to employee self-serving behaviors that are aimed at accomplishing personal goals and targets (Kacmar & Ferris, 1991). Further, general political behavior induces employees to form alliances within the system of an organization to compete for scarce resources which undertakes the use of power by some employees to influence the decision making process (Pfeffer, 1992). Second, to go ahead indicates the way in which employees adjust to the ongoing political activities in the workplace by keeping silent and being passive and inactive as means of achieving their personal goals. Third, indicates the unfair process and practices of organizations regarding employee pay, promotions, and rewards. While, it is assumed that promotions are likely to be awarded to those employees who are a good fit for the organization, some employees might use political affiliations and means to get the promotions at the cost of other employees (Kacmar & Carlson, 1997; Kacmar & Ferris, 1991).

However, drawing on the model of Ferris, Russ and Fandt (1989) employees' perceptions may not depict the actual reality. POP refers to employee experience at their workplace on which they build certain perceptions. Moreover, employees respond to their perceptions and act accordingly, which makes it more significant to study and understand POP (G. R. Ferris &

Kacmar, 1992). Workplace outcomes are more negatively affected by employee perceptions of the political climate than the actual political climate of the organization (Miller et al., 2008). POP has been negatively associated with various employee behaviors, attitudes and other workplace outcomes in the literature.

2.3 Counterproductive Work Behavior

CWB is defined in the literature as the deliberate behavior of certain individuals which can harm the other individuals in the workplace or targets the organization as a whole (Gruys & Sackett, 2003) . It also indicates a voluntary behavior of the existing employees performed to damage the interest of the organization and its members (Fox & Spector, 2005). There may be various potential reasons to develop such behavior in individuals; one could be lack of motivation to comply with organizational requirements and norms or enough motivation to perform against the organizational requirements (Kaplan, 1975) . Similarly, it is also defined as behaviors that range from active which includes (theft, sabotage, aggression) to passive which may include withdrawal behavior (Conlon, Meyer, & Nowakowski, 2005). CWB is a workplace phenomenon, identified in the organization as activities that are damaging and hurtful for both individuals and the organization at large. The severity of these damaging acts can range from extreme negativity to premeditated problems at the workplace for oneself and others. Another way to understand what originated the idea of CWB in employees is the lack of discretionary behavior towards their coworkers and organization (Kaplan, 1975).

Other researchers have also defined CWB as organizational CWB-O based or interpersonal CWB-I. To understand CWB-O it is assumed that specific intentions of employees which are directly targeting behavior to harm the organization, while CWB-I is

assumed as the intentions of employees which are directly targeting the interest to harm the other members in the workplace (Bennett & Robinson, 2000).

To better understand the mechanism through which CWB influences different targets at the workplace their distinctions as CWB-O and CWB-I has become crucial (Dalal, 2005; Sakurai & Jex, 2012). Though it has been categorized into five main dimensions, it can further be divided into two main broader classifications which are CWB-O and CWB-I. For more comprehensive understanding Spector et al., (2006) have presented five main categories of CWB which includes theft, withdrawal, sabotage, abuse and production deviance. Firstly, theft indicates stealing from the organization. Second, withdrawal is defined as being absent from the workplace, taking unnecessarily long pauses from working and quitting early without a good reason. Third, sabotage is defined as the destruction of an organization's stock, assets, and properties as well as the atmosphere of the business. Fourth, production deviation can be understood as employees carrying out operational work slowly, with faults, and while intentionally not adhering to orders from the organization or supervisor. The fifth is the abuse which involves engaging employees in violent behavior, harassing other workers, and endangering the group as whole as well as individual members. First four categories define CWB which are directed toward organization mainly falls in the broader sub dimension of CWB-O and the last abuse is defined as directed towards the other employees in the organizations related well with the CWB-I. Besides this, the past literature has defined CWB into more than two and five categories. However, all the classifications have similarities and they relate to the main five categories presented by Spector et al., (2006).

It's crucial for organizations to understand CWB as they elaborate the process through which employees damage the interest of other employees and the moral values and norms of the

organization. CWB refers to the dark side of behaviors employees demonstrate at their workplaces (Spain, Harms, & LeBreton, 2014). It also refers to employees' negative behavior that includes gossip, wasting time at work by daydreaming and wasting resources at the workplace (Bennett & Robinson, 2000). As a result, CWB has a number of detrimental effects on both people and organizations as it causes the organizations to face numerous losses (Dunlop & Lee, 2004; Hung, Chi, & Lu, 2009).

2.4 Turnover Intention

Turnover intention is defined as an employee's decision regarding change of the current employment within a specified period of time (Sousa-Poza & Henneberger, 2004). Other researchers have defined it as an individual's willful and volunteer choice to permanently depart from their organization (Price, 2001). When employees tend to wish and plan about their permanent change of current jobs, it depicts the process of turnover intention (L. J. Williams & Hazer, 1986).

Turnover intentions can lead towards employee actual turnover (Bigliardi, Petroni, & Ivo Dormio, 2005). Employee turnover might be the most important indicator for effective management of human resources in the workplace, as it can bring huge costs in the shape of new recruitments (Hayward et al., 2016). When employees develop feelings that they don't belong to the current organization, turnover intentions become the last stage in which they plan to leave their organization in certain circumstances (Tett & Meyer, 1993). Turnover intention is a process which takes psychological steps to finally reach actual turnover; first employees evaluate their satisfaction at their current organizations and job, secondly they search for possible alternatives that they can switch and in the last they make comparisons of the alternatives with their current jobs and organizations (Mobley, 1977). Turnover intention might pose a serious

threat to the organizations as it reduces the productivity levels in the organization as skilled labor might leave and organizational investment on their experienced employees become a loss (Shaw, Gupta, & Delery, 2005). It is imperative for organizations to be aware of the factors that affect employee turnover intentions as it is an important source to understand the reasons for actual turnover and its consequences in the organization. The researchers are making efforts to understand the mechanisms of turnover intention in employees as it is considered as one of the root problems that prevails in the workplace and is giving tough time to employers to detect it. When employees are not provided with the appropriate atmosphere for their mental and physical health to function in, they might start looking for other organizations that provide them with the right environment. Employee turnover has two categories: one is voluntary turnover and the other is involuntary turnover. First, employees' voluntary turnover includes making a choice to leave the job by themselves due to various reasons such as negative work environment, load of work, alternative job opportunities and tension from the boss. The involuntary turnover is the decision of an employer to terminate the job of their employees for the reasons of bad performance or not being able to perform at work (Dess & Shaw, 2001). The voluntary turnover might be caused by employees' intentions to quit and is a great concern for employers as it influences the functioning of the organization (Farasat et al., 2021). Numerous researchers have discovered a reliable and constant connection between the desire to leave and employee voluntary turnover (Wright & Bonett, 2007).

2.5 Workplace Ostracism

Workplace ostracism involves ignoring and isolating an individual or a group or reducing the possibility of social interactions at the workplace (D. L. Ferris, Brown, et al., 2008). Ostracism is not a new phenomenon, its traces are found back in history; studies reveal that

examples of shunning and excluding individuals and groups by other individuals and groups were prevalent long ago from around 500 B.C at the time of early Greek Civilization in different clans till the present day. In the past, tribes used the term (ostrakismos) for ostracism where a person was exiled from the state as a punishment for 10 years. Ostracism is also defined as a process formed with the integration of biological and cultural aspects; several studies have found it common not only in human beings but in several other species. In the past ostracism was a popular mechanism to punish the deviant behaviors of humans observed through both legal and informal ways, even children socially excluding their fellows to punish them for their unusual behaviors was a common form of ostracism (K. D. Williams, 1997, 2007). Generally workplace ostracism includes not inviting, speaking or not involving in different group activities to a particular employee (Robinson et al., 2013). Ostracized individuals might experience a shock at the initial level followed by emotional pain. However, the feelings of ostracism grasp the individual first, before they actually conclude the reason behind such treatment of ostracism (K. D. Williams, 2007). In the second phase ostracized employees are followed by stress and inevitable psychological issues (Heaphy & Dutton, 2008).

In literature different terms have been used to define experience having similarities with workplace ostracism, such as rejection, social exclusion, shunning, interpersonal mistreatment and linguistic ostracism. Individuals are often directly or indirectly refused to have social connections in the organizations, thus when individuals want to build connections, they might clearly hear a no from others; the term rejection has been used for such situations in the literature. Individuals being denied of getting part of a social circle are referred in literature as social exclusion (Blackhart, Nelson, Knowles, & Baumeister, 2009). Shunning takes the form of organized rejection (Anderson, 2009). Interpersonal mistreatment encompasses the situation in

which a person is eliminated from social interactions (Cullen, Fan, & Liu, 2014). Even when there is a dialogue in a particular language between two individuals or a group that one might not be able to understand, the conversation can induce an interpersonal stressor, named as linguistic ostracism (Albana & Yeşiltaş, 2021).

Workplace ostracism proves to be a threat for employees' basic psychological needs such as need to belong, self-esteem, employee feelings of meaningful existence in their workplace, and their sense of control, thus it has an immense impact on employees in the workplace (K. D. Williams, 2002). As with the passage of time victims of workplace ostracism are deprived of social interactions at the workplace, it has negative implications for employee behavior and attitudes as well as for their mental health (D. L. Ferris, Lian, Brown, & Morrison, 2015). Workplace ostracism proves damaging for employee psychological wellbeing (Wu, Yim, Kwan, & Zhang, 2012) and negatively impacts their physical health (Heaphy & Dutton, 2008). Moreover, organizations also suffer from ostracized employees' negative job attitudes and decreased job performance (Sharma & Dhar, 2021). Workplace ostracism as an interpersonal stressor also becomes the evident cause of employee mental stress (K. D. Williams, 1997, 2007). Victims of ostracism suffer from various negative consequences such as life distress, sleep issues (Y. Chen & Li, 2019) and might disturb their work life balance by inducing family-work conflict (R. Zhang, Ye, & Ferreira-Meyers, 2017). Researchers in the past have linked workplace ostracism to signs of anxiety, reduced satisfaction in employees at work and feelings of depression (D. L. Ferris, Berry, Brown, & Lian, 2008; Hitlan, Clifton, & DeSoto, 2006).

2.6 Hostile Attribution Bias

The term hostile attribution bias emphasizes on the mental outlook of certain Individuals who are prone to blame others for every negative or unique situation (Adams & John, 1997). It

also discusses the propensity for some individuals to perceive the actions of those around them characterized with hostile intention (Chabrol, Van Leeuwen, Rodgers, & Séjourné, 2009). In an attempt to understand the root cause of employees displaying hostile attribution bias, researchers have investigated that individuals who have experienced traumatic events in childhood and continue to deal with them even in their adolescence are more likely to perceive unique and ambiguous actions of others as hostile, threatening, and targeted toward themselves (Dodge & Coie, 1987). Thus one of the main reasons for the dispositional attribution style of individuals is due to the persistent exposure to state of threat and hostile behaviors of others (Dodge et al., 2015). Further, individuals assume that other people's actions are hostile in nature, especially when in a social context they experience situations that are vague, unpredictable, or challenging to comprehend. Hostile attribution bias also makes individuals behave in an inappropriate way and with more aggression when they perceive others' behavior as intentional to harm them or threaten them (Milich & Dodge, 1984).

Higher degrees of dispositional attribution style leads people to assume the malicious intent behind an action, whether it is related to the behaviors of other people or a situation that concerns the whole organization (Milich & Dodge, 1984). It is the understanding of actions and situations as being negative even when the intent behind them is not clear (Matthews & Norris, 2002). Moreover, some scholars have identified it as an important facet of an individual's personality which has become stable over time, under this justification two responses are discussed (Douglas & Martinko, 2001). One response is that individuals confidently assume that others' actions are purposefully hostile towards them. Conversely, another response is related to those who rarely exhibit hostile attribution bias and view others wrongdoings and harsh

behaviors as acceptable, assuming that others have no control on their behaviors and some external factors are responsible for it.

Hostile attribution bias first significantly influences unpleasant situations at the workplace after that it determines what behavioral responses need to be undertaken (Hoobler & Brass, 2006). The outcomes of hostile attribution bias are evident in individuals displaying more aggressive (Judge, Scott, & Ilies, 2006) and deviant behaviors at the workplace (Douglas & Martinko, 2001).

2.7 Underpinning theory

2.7.1 Social Exchange Theory

The current study applies social exchange theory to understand the association among variables under consideration for the study. The theory is popularly discussed in the literature across various fields as it plays a crucial role in understanding employees' attitudes and behaviors at the workplace (Cropanzano & Mitchell, 2005). It is not a new concept as traces of social exchange theory are available in the literature from the beginning of 20th century (Khan, Khan, & Gul, 2019), it also incorporates a number of academic fields, including sociology (Blau, 1964), social psychology (Homans, 1958) and anthropology (Firth, 1967). Though there are several schools of thought regarding how to interpret the theory in different disciplines, scholars all agree that the process of social exchange constitutes reciprocal obligations to be fulfilled by a series of interactions (Emerson, 1976). The theory has also made efforts to integrate the concepts from sociology and psychology to better explain how individuals behave and the structure of their social relations at the workplace (Kim & Qu, 2020).

Literature has highlighted three foundational ideas that elaborate the purpose and understanding of social exchange theory (Cropanzano & Mitchell, 2005). First, reciprocity is one

of the main pillars of social exchange theory. Social exchanges encompass norms and rules regarding negotiations and reciprocity. Reciprocity can further be explained as an interdependent exchange where one party supplies something of benefit and the receiving party has to return the benefit (Gouldner, 1960) . Further reciprocity norms are characterized with quid pro quo tendencies that can take the form of both advantageous and detrimental exchanges (Cropanzano, Anthony, Daniels, & Hall, 2017; Cropanzano & Mitchell, 2005). Negative reciprocity refers to the act of repaying negative behaviors in exchange for negative treatment, whereas positive reciprocity refers to repaying positive treatment. On the other hand, the goal of negotiated rules is to arrive at advantageous agreements, such as individuals or groups negotiating their tasks and responsibilities at work. Second idea is related to exchange of resources, which can be socio-emotional or economic (Foa & Foa, 1974). Socio-emotional resources represent aspects of an individual's emotional and social relations, these resources are exchanged to achieve personal and social goals, whereas economic resources can be exchanged to meet financial demands. Although social exchange theory and economic exchange theory are often compared, there is a clear distinction between the two ideas (Blau, 1964). Economic exchanges are fulfilled as legal obligations, contrary to that social exchanges involve relationships where failure to fulfill an obligation can pose a serious threat to the strength of a relationship even when no party is bound in any legal agreement (Blau, 1964). Third, relationships are developed over time due to social exchanges where people show concern for others, leading to the development of positive interpersonal relationships (Cropanzano, Byrne, Bobocel, & Rupp, 2001). The core of these interpersonal relationships is loyalty, trust, and two way commitments and to sustain these relationships both parties must comply by specific "exchange rules". These rules are also the guidelines for successful social exchanges (Emerson, 1976).

However, POP refers to self-serving political actions of some employees that endanger the interests of others, employees actively engaged in political behaviors, avoid teamwork, reduce interaction with coworkers, withhold information from others, and defame others for attention. All these negative behaviors lead to diminish the positive interpersonal exchange relationships at work (Büyükyılmaz & Biçer, 2019). POP from a negative social exchange perspective might potentially predict interpersonal stressor at work such as ostracism.

Moreover, in a political workplace climate employees might perceive that their contributions are not appreciated, and they are not valued in their organization which creates an imbalance in the positive exchange relationship between the organizations and its employees. Similarly, when employees are deprived of social interactions and relationships at work in the form of ostracism, their exchange relationship is compromised. To balance the exchange relationship, employees will return the unfair treatment through reducing positive contributions and engaging more in negative behaviors such as CWB (Crawford, Lamarre, Kacmar, & Harris, 2019; Fatima, 2016). Further, social exchange theory is also applicable to comprehend the reason for employee turnover intention. POP and workplace ostracism both violates the psychological contract between employees and their organization, when employees are not given an appropriate environment for work they will not be able to perform better and will demonstrate low satisfaction and engagement with their jobs that eventually leads to turnover intention (Azeem, Bajwa, Shahzad, & Aslam, 2020).

2.8 POP and Employee Outcomes

Organizations have scarce resources and employees in a highly politically charged environment tend to be involved in influence tactics and sometimes also take credit of others' efforts and work to get rewarded. POP literature suggests that the work environment induces and

pressurizes employees to pursue political activities to accomplish their goals and objectives in the organization (Lazarus & Folkman, 1984). Such a political environment is perceived as stressful for employees which has adverse consequences for employee's health and wellbeing which eventually hampers their performance at work. Literature has also proven negative and far reaching consequences of POP on employee outcomes in the organizational framework. However, researchers identify that there is a dearth of research on explaining POP and employee outcomes in detail. In response to uncertainty and ambiguity linked with the political environment employees feel lower job satisfaction and strain and they even tend to move out of their organizations to find a less stressful work environment (Delle, 2013; Miller et al., 2008). Employee turnover intentions are caused by several reasons that formulate the core of a workplace environment such as motivation, effective communications, and presence of organizational support, promotions and incentives. Thus, the importance of organizational atmosphere is evident in developing employee intentions. Employees' perception of their organizational environment decreases their motivation and demoralizes them which play a crucial role in developing employee intentions to leave their jobs. POP is the source of developing negative feelings in employees, as a recent study investigated that POP is significantly associated with job anxiety that predicts employee turnover intentions at the workplace (Haider, Fatima, & de Pablos-Heredero, 2020). Another study discussed the political environment as a source of stress for employees (Ali et al., 2021), thus, employees in such an environment might refuse to adhere to others' self-serving behaviors and search for alternative jobs where there is less political maneuvering (Clercq et al., 2021).

Employees who assume high levels of politics at the workplace may build an opinion that self-interested behavior yields incentives and that there are fewer expectations of being loyal

towards organization and having respect for others (Witt & Spector, 2012). As a result, employees in highly political organizations potentially initiate CWB and normalize taking advantage of others (A. Cohen, 2016; Zettler & Hilbig, 2010). Furthermore, employees will establish negative perceptions of their organization and may retaliate with enhanced CWB if they consider that the workplace is functioning by unconventional systems and regulations and that politics, rather than performance and contribution, drive most decisions in the organization. Employees' POP tend to negatively impact their belief system that their organization has just and fair processes, moreover, once employees lose faith in the organizational procedures they potentially respond with CWB (A. Cohen & Diamant, 2019). Recent studies have highlighted the negative consequences of POP such as burnout (Makhdoom, Mehmood, & Atta, 2017) and hostility towards others and organization that becomes the prime cause of employee CWB in an organization (Meisler et al., 2019).

The current research takes support from the social exchange perspective of defining POP and employee outcomes (C. Chang et al., 2009). Social exchange theory has been widely used to study mutual relationships between employees and organizations. If organizations treat their employees fairly and provide them social support, then employees feel obligated to return to the organization with positive behaviors and attitudes. Organizational politics creates an environment which involves unjust and unfair practices, thus employees' perceptions of such an environment can result in negative employee outcomes such as CWB and turnover intention. According to the discussion presented above the study on hand aims to find the association between POP and employee outcomes in the private corporate sector of Pakistan.

Hypothesis 1: POP is positively associated with employee CWB

Hypothesis 2: POP is positively associated with employee turnover intention

2.9 POP and Workplace Ostracism

In the light of social exchange theory interpersonal relationships are based on certain social exchanges that can be explained from a cost-benefit approach, where a person anticipates that the benefits of the social exchange transaction will outweigh the costs the interpersonal relationship will tend to grow. However, frequently engaging in political activities requires putting one owns' interest ahead of others, thus those who are not directly benefited from exchange relationships are more inclined to see those interactions negatively which hampers the smooth functioning of social exchange relationships (Khan et al., 2019). Additionally, experiencing the poor state of social exchange relationships amid political activities employees might assume their roles as low-contributing social exchange partners which further make them feel isolated from each other (Scott et al., 2013). Furthermore, employees are unwilling to communicate and maintain relationships with individuals who become the cause for facilitating an untrustworthy work environment (X. Zhang & Dai, 2015), which is typically driven by organizational politics leading to unfavorable interactions such as workplace ostracism. Furthermore, it is believed that POP is likely to erode professional relationships based on reciprocity and trust (Bai, Han, & Harms, 2016; Malik et al., 2019), leading to a higher sense of ostracism. Numerous undesirable employee outcomes, including job burnout, discontent with work, intention to leave, lower organizational commitment, and poorer job performance, are linked to perceptions of higher levels of organizational politics (Asrar-ul-Haq et al., 2019; Bai et al., 2016; Landells & Albrecht, 2017; Malik et al., 2019), thus it is assumed that POP will potentially predict more negative outcomes such as workplace ostracism. The literature has further discussed the role of POP and its linkage with interpersonal stressors such as interpersonal distrust and workplace incivility (D. N. Karim et al., 2021; Ogungbamila, 2013).

On the basis of discussion above and support from the previous literature the current study proposes that POP will be responsible for creating an environment for interpersonal stressor such as workplace ostracism. Thus, it is hypothesized that:

Hypothesis 3: POP is positively associated with workplace ostracism.

2.10 Mediating role of Workplace Ostracism

Workplace ostracism is an unpleasant and painful experience for employees; it serves as an active source of stress that becomes the prime cause of many difficulties such as reducing employee motivation at work (Wu et al., 2012). It is the feeling of an individual of being ignored and left out at work by other members which reduces the frequency of social interactions among employees which results in low contributing workforce. The problem of workplace ostracism is prevalent in various sectors, the research has been increasing in this particular interest area and its potential effects on employee behaviors, attitudes and wellbeing have been explored to gain better understanding of the phenomenon (Li et al., 2021). However, it's crucial to identify the factors that can potentially aid in developing an atmosphere for ostracism to flourish in the workplace and to identify and eradicate the root cause of such unpleasant experiences. Researchers have made efforts to highlight personal and contextual antecedents of workplace ostracism, though few have discussed the factors relating to circumstances or events that have the potential to predict this phenomenon.

The importance of environmental factors as antecedents of workplace ostracism has been discussed by the researchers (Robinson et al., 2013; K. D. Williams, 2007), still few studies have empirically tested this stream. A recent meta-analysis study has highlighted the importance of supporting a workplace environment which can reduce the incidents of workplace ostracism. However when employees feel that they have no social support either from their coworkers or

organizations they feel ostracized as they have no one to share their grievances with (Howard, Cogswell, & Smith, 2019). Similarly, when employees perceive that their organizational climate is characterized by unfair processes and self-serving behaviors of others, they might develop feelings of being left out from the social context of their workplace.

Employees function in a social setting at their work, where every individual has to interact with other individuals to get things done. As individuals are involved in a series of interactions on a daily basis, they build exchange relationships with other members at the workplace. Smooth functioning of such an exchange relationship is dependent on various factors such as mutual trust and understanding, perceived fairness in every interaction and the way employees behave with each other at work. Since, organizational politics has become a prevalent phenomenon, which is characterized with employee behaviors that have detrimental effects for others. Further research has discussed that employee perceptions regarding these unethical, illegitimate and unfair behaviors that are prominent in a political organization can pose a great threat to exchange relationships (Chinomona & Mofokeng, 2016). POP plays a major role in developing employees' feelings of anxiety and powerlessness, tension among interpersonal relationships and an increased sense of self protection against unreasonable behaviors and processes at the workplace (Sun & Xia, 2018). Moreover, it can trigger conflicts regarding work tasks, interpersonal relationships and develop feelings of distrust among employees (Bai et al., 2016; Ullah, Hasnain, Khalid, & Aslam, 2019). Eventually, all the negative consequences of POP aid in creating a viable environment for the development of interpersonal stressor such as workplace ostracism.

Employees play a vital role in determining an organization's success. However, workplace ostracism impacts various employee outcomes which makes it crucial for

organizations to study the phenomenon. Literature has defined the experience of workplace ostracism as a social pain or social death for its victims (Mao, Liu, Jiang, & Zhang, 2018; K. D. Williams, 2007). Employees are distracted from their work as they exhaust their energies dealing with ostracism which results in reduced engagement and low performance at work (Xu, Kwan, & Li, 2020). Moreover, it's devastating effects psychologically frustrate the employees and reduce their self-esteem, which results in less motivation to exhibit pro social behaviors and give rise to deviant behaviors at the workplace (Peng & Zeng, 2017). Recent studies also documented workplace ostracism to be the potential cause of employees engaging in aggressive and CWB (Y. Chen & Li, 2020; Jahanzeb & Fatima, 2018). Further, in the light of social exchange theory, it is well established that all the social interaction among employees relies on the principle of exchange. The exchange process encompasses the norms of fairness as well reciprocity. If employees are treated with respect and trust they will return the same. However, when employees are not treated well, they may retaliate in the form of CWB. As workplace ostracism diminishes the exchange relationship, the employees' will find it justified to exhibit their CWB towards those who exclude them or their organizations. Studies have supported the use of social exchange theory to explain the association of workplace ostracism with various categories of CWB (R. Chen & Song, 2019; Fatima, 2016).

Another possible negative consequence of workplace ostracism that gained the attention of current study is employee turnover intention. The main motivation behind an employee's intended departure is to avoid the existing devastating circumstances that are causing him to feel left out at the workplace and repeatedly impairs both his physical and mental health. After being ostracized, an employee's attempts to mend his social contacts at the beginning stage, however a failure to do so develops feelings to eventually leave the organization (Vui-Yee & Yen-Hwa,

2020). Getting ignored by coworkers repeatedly may deplete an individual's efforts to reconnect with those who initiate workplace ostracism which results in intentions to quit. Moreover, turnover intention serves as a defensive mechanism for employees who are considering leaving their current jobs, to shield themselves from emotional suffering caused by workplace ostracism (Fiset, Al Hajj, & Vongas, 2017). Recently scholars have also found the result of workplace ostracism to be positively associated with employee turnover intention. Workplace Ostracism emotionally exhausts employees and the feelings of burnout exacerbate the intentions to leave the organization (Farasat et al., 2021). According to the assumptions of social exchange theory in a situation where employees face exploitation of organizational norms or psychological violations they respond with turnover intention (Ngo-Henha, 2018) and might actually leave their organizations eventually which is a huge loss for the employer. Based on discussion made above following hypotheses are proposed:

Hypothesis 4: Workplace ostracism has a positive association with CWB

Hypothesis 5: Workplace ostracism has a positive association with turnover intention

Hypothesis 6: Workplace ostracism mediates the relationship between POP and CWB

Hypothesis 7: Workplace Ostracism mediates the relationship between POP and turnover intention

2.11 Moderating Role of Hostile Attribution Bias

Hostile attribution bias is defined as the disposition in attributing styles of the individual. Individuals make faulty attributions when they make the same positive or negative attributions across different situations. It is the distorted perception of an individual to relate destructive motives for others' actions even when their intentions are pure or the situation is unclear (Kokkinos, Karagianni, & Voulgaridou, 2017). Other studies have shown that a person with high

hostile attribution bias has a tendency to call out others for every benign or unpleasant situation and perceive their behavior as hostile (Matthews & Norris, 2002). Additionally, researchers have investigated that hostile attribution bias greatly influences aggravating circumstances that set the direction for employee reactions (Hoobler & Brass, 2006) and that it may also drive aggressiveness (Kokkinos et al., 2017), reduce job satisfaction and develop intentions to quit the organization (Harvey, Harris, & Martinko, 2008).

Dark personality traits may predict an employee's hostile attribution bias (Hansen-Brown & Freis, 2021; Law & Falkenbach, 2018; Moon & Lee, 2021), that over the time becomes a stable part of an individual's personality. Attribution style or bias may be one of the most important parts of an individual's personality as under social exchange theory dark personality traits have the potential to result in negative workplace outcomes (Forsyth, Banks, & McDaniel, 2012). Drawing on this assumption, employees implying a negative lens to every benign or negative situation in the workplace pose a potential threat to the positive social exchange relationship. To balance the exchange relationship, employees perceiving hostile situations may attract more negative situations or retaliate in more aggressive ways if they face actual negative circumstances (Klein Tunte, Bogaerts, & Veling, 2019). As individuals having a high hostile attribution bias are very observant of their organizational context that may have either positive or negative cues (Milich & Dodge, 1984). Such individuals refuse to take responsibility for their roles in a social exchange, rather becoming skeptical and attaching negativity and anger to the other participants involved in the process.

Moreover, it has gained considerable attention in the literature as a potential boundary condition between various negative associations to demonstrate the effect of individual differences in interpreting the situation or behaviors that can strengthen or weaken any given

relationship. For instance employees who have high attribution bias, if treated in uncivil ways from other employees or their supervisors may retaliate in the same negative way without knowing the actual intent behind such ill treatment, they instantly perceive that others are purposefully targeting them (Wu, Zhang, Chiu, Kwan, & He, 2014). Negative gossiping is another event in the social context that is perceived negatively by employees and it may trigger negative employee outcomes, employees with high hostile attribution bias are more prone to justify the negative gossiping by others as having hostile intent (Kong, 2018). Recent study on explaining the association workplace ostracism and emotional exhaustion tested that employees with high hostile attribution bias reported increased effects on their emotional exhaustion caused by workplace ostracism (Qi, Cai, Liu, & Feng, 2020).

The literature suggests that the element of uncertainty and role of ambiguity is prominent in employees' perceptions of workplace ostracism (K. D. Williams, 2002). If the employees are actually ostracized by other individuals there is a possibility that the initiators of ostracism are not aware of their own actions (Robinson et al., 2013). On the contrary, if there are purposeful incidents of workplace ostracism, the victims sometimes are not able to judge the actual intent behind such acts (D. L. Ferris, Berry, et al., 2008). Workplace ostracism might result in various negative employee outcomes and stressful situations (Bedi, 2021), which might be conditional on various factors (Qi et al., 2020). Therefore, the discussion above highlights the importance to investigate the moderating role of hostile attribution to report any change in the association between workplace ostracism and employee outcomes.

Hypothesis 8: Hostile attribution bias moderates the relationship between workplace ostracism and CWB such that the positive relationship is stronger in case of high attribution bias.

Hypothesis 9: Hostile attribution bias moderates the relationship between workplace ostracism and turnover intention such that the positive relationship is stronger in case of high attribution bias.

Furthermore, POP also have elements of uncertainty and ambiguity as employee perceptions are not always the true picture of reality. Different individuals make different perceptions regarding their work environment. Those who perceived organizational politics as a negative workplace phenomenon would experience reduced job satisfaction, job burnout and low commitment towards their organization (Asrar-ul-Haq et al., 2019; C. Chang et al., 2009; Miller et al., 2008) and may retaliate in the worst possible ways (Meisler et al., 2019). On the other hand some employees might not perceive it as a threat and they behave the other way (Landells & Albrecht, 2017). The study on hand proposes that individuals with high hostile attribution may perceive organizational politics as a threat to their social exchange relationship with their organization and other coworkers and indulge in more negative behaviors to return the negative exchange and develop increased intentions to quit their current jobs to join some other organizations which is not involved in political maneuvering. On the basis of arguments made above, hostile attribution may play the role of a catalyst and exacerbate the proposed positive relationship between POP and employee negative outcomes.

Hypothesis 10: Employees' hostile attribution bias moderates the indirect effect of POP on CWB through workplace ostracism such that the indirect effect is stronger when hostile attribution bias is high.

Hypothesis 11: Employees' hostile attribution bias moderates the indirect effect of POP on turnover intention through workplace ostracism such that the indirect effect is stronger when hostile attribution bias is high.

2.12 Theoretical Framework

Based on the discussion above in the light of social exchange theory, following is the conceptual model of the present study:

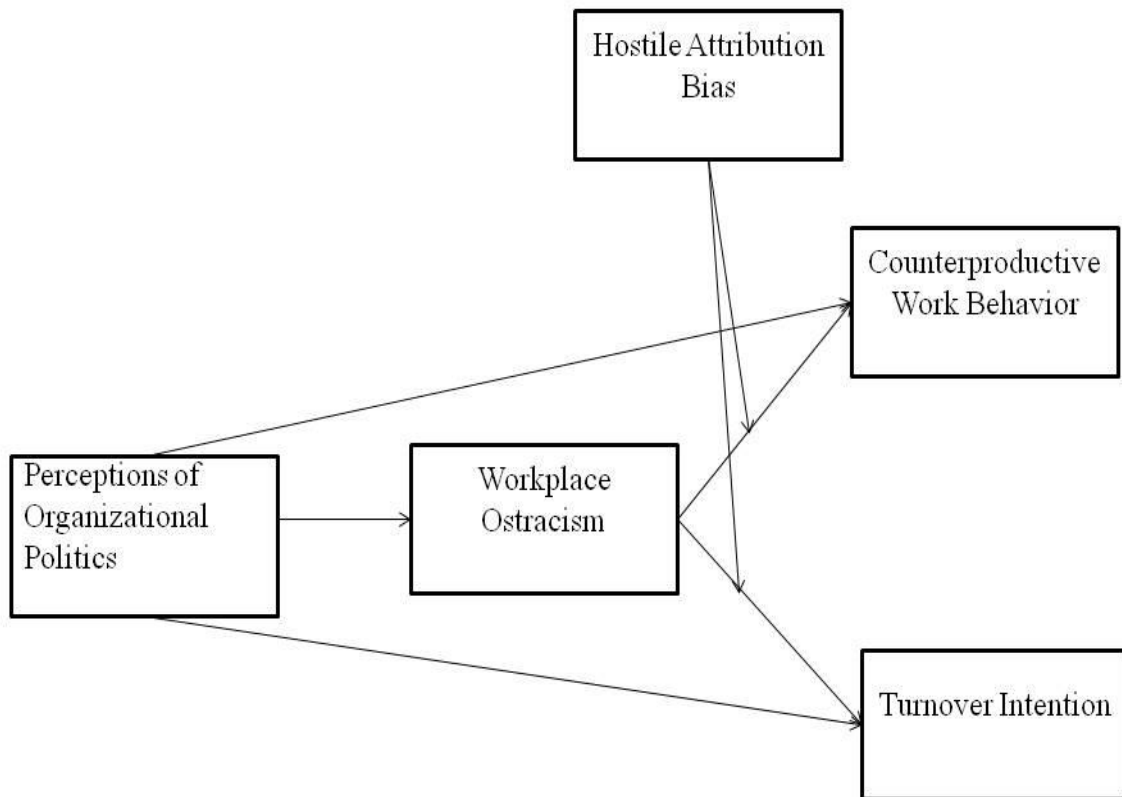


Figure 2.1

Theoretical Framework

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Chapter Overview

This chapter serves to provide a road map to describe the methodology used by the researcher for conducting the present study. The chapter initially discusses research philosophy, strategy and approach for the study, design of study, data collection method, population size suitable for the study, strategy, size and technique for the sample and unit of analysis. Further it gives details regarding the questionnaire and its sources that the study has adopted required information of respondent's profile and the ethical consideration crucial for the purpose of eliminating researcher biases. The readers of the study are also informed regarding the statistical software's and techniques which are incorporated for data analysis.

3.2 Research Philosophy

The current study, like all other studies, is based on a set of beliefs, viewpoints and a depiction of association with its environment which is defined as a research paradigm. It includes philosophies, a set of beliefs and certain principles that become the guideline to choose a rational research strategy, design and method to undertake for the current study. It is crucial for a researcher to wisely opt for any of the research paradigms before starting work on the study as this particular decision substantially influences all the research activities and it makes it easy for the researcher to fully understand what is being researched.

There are two main research paradigms; "positivist paradigm and interpretive paradigm" (Bell, Harley, & Bryman, 2015; Myers, 2019). The positivist paradigm takes the scientific

approach and is widely used by the social science researchers. Positivists' belief considers that social reality can be investigated without the involvement of the researcher and that social life can be quantitatively represented through developing constructs that can later be investigated through casual relationships and experiments (Creswell & Creswell, 2017). On the other hand, interpretive approach refers to the qualitative research design that considers the broader sense of reality which is driven by human experiences and interests. In qualitative research design the data is collected through participant observation or through the different interviewing techniques. The current study adopts the positivist paradigm and its underlying philosophy. The quantitative research technique is used in order to collect data from the selected sample which represents the entire targeted population. As the positivism approach focuses more on numbers, established facts from quantified data, generalizability followed by the validity of data through the use of survey methods, thus, it will be the most rational choice for the current study.

3.3 Research Design

Research design calls for the methods and procedures used to assist in acquiring and analyzing the data on the study variables which are already specified in the research problem. Moreover, it discusses the strategy, organization, and plan created to solve certain research issues highlighted in this study.

For the better understanding of research design best suited for current study all three categories of research design were deeply studied. First is the exploratory research design, which incorporates a set of data to analyze and answer the questions such as why and how, regarding a phenomenon. Second, the descriptive research design serves the answers to questions such as when, what, where. Third is the causal research design which explains the causal

associations between the independent and the dependent variables and investigates the cause and effect.

The current study reflects the descriptive and exploratory research design. On one hand the study explores the mediating role of interpersonal stressor which is workplace ostracism for the first time between employee perceptions of their organizational politics and undesirable employee outcomes discussed in this study which are turnover intention and CWB. Through exploring the role of a new mediator, the current study is expected to positively contribute towards the existing literature on POP and employee outcomes. This study also incorporates the descriptive research design as it discusses all variables of the study in detail and sheds light on their past and current literature. Further, it also discusses the ways in which the current study contributes in highlighting the unexplored areas in literature. Third, the current study's research design is mainly casual in nature as it tests the association between different variables. Furthermore, the cause and effect method is most suitable for the study on hand to define the association among various study variables that may or may not be linked before.

This study tests various hypotheses that address how employee perceptions of organizational politics affects employee outcome through incorporating a moderated mediation approach, employing a cross-sectional research design. As the current study will confirm or reject the hypotheses which are developed in the light of past theories from literature, the approach to carry out the research will be deductive. Furthermore, this study employs a Google survey form to collect responses and quantify them for the purpose of conducting quantitative research. Thus, the postulated relationships were investigated by empirically testing the hypotheses using data obtained by the online survey approach. Data is collected in a single time frame from all the respondents; thus, the study has used a cross sectional data collection method.

Since the topic of this research is based on the employee perceptions of their environment and their interpersonal relationships with others that shape their intentions and behavior, the study used self-report scales to collect data for independent, mediating and dependent variables. Furthermore, the moderating variable gives information about employee's attribution style that is also obtained through self-reported scale.

3.4 Population of the Study

The set of items, events or people that the researcher is most interested in studying for the purpose of interpreting and drawing conclusions from is defined as the population of that study. The target population of the current study is the employees from the private sector of Pakistan working in different companies located in the twin cities of Rawalpindi/Islamabad. The reason for targeting the private sector is the perception of people regarding politics as the part of public organizations, whereas politics is evident in every organization regardless of its sector or nature of business. Moreover, the data is collected from the employees of human resource and administration (HR/A) of different organizations such as real estate firms, software service providing firms and marketing firms for the purpose of getting responses from diverse sources for better generalizability of results.

3.5 Unit of Analysis

Employees working in the HR/A department at all levels are the unit of analysis for the current study. The reason for choosing this department is its involvement with employees of all other departments of the organization. The study assumes that employees through survey questionnaires will give a better idea of how employee's perceptions are built in the organization that can pose a threat to positive workplace outcomes.

3.6 Sample and Data Collection

The sampling strategy used by the present study to collect responses is convenience sampling which is one of the non-probability sampling techniques. The reason for applying this sampling method is that the current study targets various organizations in twin cities, i.e. (Islamabad/Rawalpindi) to get responses and it was difficult for the author to get details of all the organizations. Furthermore, it was not possible to communicate the survey details at once to all the participants as they belong to different organizations.

The researchers in the literature propose a minimum sample size based on the type of research design for any particular study that can range from moderate to complex research designs. 200-400 sample size is suggested depending on the research design (Burmeister & Aitken, 2012; Delice, 2010). As the study collects data in a cross-sectional fashion and all the measures of study are self-reported the survey forms were delivered to a sample of 400 employees. The researcher of the study has received 320 forms in return, which shows a good response rate. Moreover, the survey forms were personally administered to respondents through emails and social media platforms such as LinkedIn through personal resources which ensured the good response rate. Online Google form was constructed to conduct the survey from the employees of various organizations in the private sector. The items of the questionnaire are adopted from previous research and administered according to the demand of the study. As English is used officially by most of the private sector organizations operating in the private sector of Pakistan, the researcher of the study administered all questions accordingly.

3.7 Questionnaire and Measures

This study has undertaken five latent variables in the study which are perceptions of organizational politics, workplace ostracism, counterproductive work behavior, turnover

intention and hostile attribution bias. The scales of these latent variables are well established and pre-validated in the literature. The present study to ensure the integrity of responses has adopted the scales already developed for the variables of the study from the literature. The common practice from previous studies suggests having two parts in the survey form; one related to demographics and other related to the items of the study variables. Demographic part includes questions that address the personal information of the respondent required for the study such as age, gender, income and job experience. The second portion contains 50 items reflective of the study variables. The questionnaire is attached in appendix A for further reference.

3.7.1 Perceptions of Organizational Politics

To measure perceptions of organizational politics the current study used a 12 item scale developed by (Kacmar & Ferris, 1991). The scale is used as a unidimensional construct as already used and validated by previous studies (De Clercq, Haq, & Azeem, 2018; D. N. Karim et al., 2021). Sample items included, “People don't speak up for fear of retaliation” and “People build themselves up by tearing others down” the items were measured on a 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree). Cronbach’s alpha for the scale in the current study is reported as (0.95).

3.7.2 Counterproductive Work Behavior

The study used the scale of CWB developed by (Bennett & Robinson, 2000). The 19-item scale was measured on a 7-point Likert scale ranging from 1(never) to 7 (daily). The scale is used in previous studies that reported its good reliability and validity (Meisler et al., 2019) Sample items of the scale includes “Come into late at work without permission”, “Played a mean prank on someone at work”. The Cronbach’s alpha for the scale in current study is (0.97).

3.7.3 Workplace Ostracism

Workplace ostracism was measured by asking people how often others have treated them in a certain way in their organization. The scale was adopted from (D. L. Ferris, Brown, et al., 2008) and measured on a 7-point Likert scale ranging from 1(never) to 7 (always). Sample items are “Others refused to talk to me at work”, “Others at work treated me as if you were not there”. Cronbach’s alpha for the scale in the current study is (0.95).

3.7.4 Turnover Intention

The extent to which participants were thinking of leaving their current jobs was measured using the 3 item scale of intention to quit developed by (Colarelli, 1984). The three-item scale was measured on Likert scale ranging from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree). A sample item is: “I frequently think about quitting my job”. Cronbach’s alpha of the scale for the current study is (0.855).

3.7.5 Hostile Attribution Bias

The current study adopted the six-item hostile attribution bias scale developed by (Adams & John, 1997). The scale is used in previous studies related to hostile attribution bias and reported a good reliability measure (Kong, 2018; Qi et al., 2020). A sample item as follows: “People pretend to care more about one another than they really do”. Cronbach’s alpha for the scale in the current study is (0.858).

3.8 Control Variables

Age, gender, job experience and income group of employees was added as demographic variables. As, the results showed no variable was statically significant with the dependent variables of the study. Therefore, the study has not controlled any variable for the structural or measurement model.

3.9 Statistical Software and Techniques

The data was analyzed with the help of statistical software. For the structural equation modeling and validity of the constructs the study used Partial least square structural equation modeling (PLS-SEM) version 3.3.9. The descriptive part of the questionnaire and the correlations are performed through the statistical package for the social sciences (SPSS) version 25. Further, to test the moderated mediation effects the SPSS Process macro was used which implies a bootstrapping method to calculate results (Rockwood & Hayes, 2017).

3.10 Ethical Consideration

Employees are reluctant to express their opinions regarding their perceptions of the existence of organizational politics in their respective organizations, since the subject is of sensitive nature in the context of Pakistan and they might fear potential repercussions. Therefore, prior consent was ensured from all respondents for the purpose of conducting the survey. Moreover, the respondents were assured of the confidentiality of their responses through a cover letter which describes the purpose and use of data collection. The researcher of the current study contacted employees of various organizations through personal references and opted for a medium where the respondents were free to participate without fear of exploitation by the organization for participating in the survey. Furthermore, the respondents were informed that the data will be analyzed and interpreted in aggregate form and no independent response will be highlighted as personal details (e.g. name) of respondents is not mentioned in the write up of the thesis. The data is collected for academic purposes only and the details of data are kept confidential which is only accessible by the researcher and the supervisor of the study.

3.11 Chapter Summary

This chapter above discusses the research approach this study has adopted and the underlying philosophy that supports the overall research design. The chapter also highlights the use of a cross-sectional survey research design with the target population of private sector employees, employed in full time jobs in various organizations across twin cities. In addition, the sampling method most suitable for the study is also discussed. Furthermore, the study gives detailed explanations of the instruments used in the survey and information regarding data collection methods. Additionally, the study uses two software Smart PLS version 3.3.39 and SPSS version 25 as a tool for data analysis which aids in conducting preliminary data analysis, measurement model and structural equation modeling along with checking reliability and validity.

CHAPTER 4

DATA ANALYSIS AND RESULTS

4.1 Chapter Overview

This chapter is related to data analysis which is divided in three parts. First the chapter is concerned with discussing the demographic information and measuring the reliability and validity of constructs. Secondly, it measures all the proposed hypotheses of the study together with showing results in the respective tables and figures. Lastly, it measures the quality of structural model which summarizes that either the theoretical model is fulfilling the goodness of fit criteria or not.

4.2 Demographics of Respondents

The respondent's demographics give details on the various individual attributes, including age, gender employment history, number of years of experience and income level etc. Analyzing the demographics of respondent's aids in determining how diverse each responder is from the others. Furthermore, it is helpful for researchers in understanding the variations in the data set as it provides a crucial comparison among respondent's similarities and contrasts. Demographic information contains four questions that made up the first section of the survey for the study on hand. Demographic information was asked from the respondents through four questions with different categories defined to analyze their age, gender, experience of job and income level.

4.2.1 Gender

First question in the demographic section related to the gender of the respondents was asked using closed ended questions having two options to choose between either male or female. Data shows that 74.4% respondents were males and 25.6% respondents were females. No missing data was found during the analysis of respondents' gender.

4.2.2 Age

Second question in the demographic section gives details regarding the age of the respondents. Different age groups were defined, and respondents described their age in numbers. Categories of respondents' age were defined in five groups i.e. 18-25 years, 26 to 35 years, 36 to 45 years, 46 to 55 years, and finally 55 years and above. Age analysis demonstrated that 31.6% respondents were in the category of 18-25, 59.1% respondents were between age group of 26 to 35 years old, 8.4% respondents were between age group of 36 to 45 years old, 0.9% respondents were between age group of 46 to 55 years old, and no respondent falls in the category of 55 and above. Furthermore, there is no missing data for age.

4.2.3 Experience

Job experience was asked in question 3 from the demographic section. Respondents were asked to mention the number of years they have spent on their jobs. Six categories were defined to report job experience i.e. 0-5 years, 6 to 10 years, 11 to 15 years, 16-20 years, 21-25 years and finally 26 years and above. Responses show that 56.6% respondents were having 5 years or less experience, 31.9% respondents have between 6 to 10 years work experience, 8.8% respondents have between 11 to 15 years work experience, 1.6% respondents have 16-20 years of work experience, 1.3% have 26 years and above work experience and no one falls in 21-25 years of experience. Furthermore, no missing values are found in job experience analysis.

4.2.4 Income

Employees were also asked about their income group in the demographic section. Six categories were defined to choose income level by the respondents and the income was reported in Pakistani currency. 5.9% respondents have reported income less than Rs. 15000, 5.9% respondents opted for the income group Rs. 15000 to Rs.34000, 38.1% respondents opted for the income group RS.35, 000 to Rs. 49000, 20.0% opted for the income group Rs.50, 000 to Rs. 74,000, 9.7% opted for the age group Rs.75, 000 to Rs. 99,000 and 10.6% respondents opted for the age group 100,000 and Above. Furthermore, in data analysis for the respondent's income no missing value was found.

Table 1

Demographic Information

Characteristics	Categories	Frequency	Percentage
Gender	Male	238	74.4
	Female	82	25.6
	Total	320	100
Age	18-25	101	31.6
	26-35	189	59.1
	36-45	27	8.4
	46-55	3	0.9
	55 and Above	-	-
	Total	320	100
Experience	0-5	181	56.6
	6-10	102	31.9
	11-15	28	8.8
	16-20	5	1.6
	21-25	-	-
	26 and Above	4	1.3
	Total	320	100
Income	less than Rs.15,000	19	5.9
	Rs.35,000 to Rs. 49,000	122	38.1
	Rs.50,000 to Rs. 74,000	64	20
	Rs.75,000 to Rs. 99,000	31	9.7
	100,000 and Above	34	10.6
	Total	320	100

4.3 Descriptive Statistics

Table 2 shows means, standard deviations and correlations of the five variables used in the study. It demonstrates that workplace ostracism is positively correlated with POP ($r=.757$, $p<.001$), CWB ($r=.700$, $p<.001$) turnover intention ($r=.610$, $p<.001$) and hostile attribution bias. The mean value and standard deviation for workplace ostracism is 4.67 and 1.37 respectively. Furthermore, POP is positively correlated with hostile attribution bias ($r=.547$, $p<.001$) and turnover intention ($r=.721$, $p<.001$). The mean value and standard deviation for POP is 3.67 and 0.95 respectively. CWB is positively correlated with HAB ($r=.570$, $p<.001$), Turnover intention ($r=.472$, $p<.001$) and POP ($r=.664$, $p<.001$) The mean value and standard deviation for CWB is 3.81 and 1.35 respectively. Turnover intention is positively correlated with hostile attribution bias ($r=.620$, $p<.001$). The mean value and standard deviation for turnover intention is 3.30 and 1.02 respectively. Lastly, for hostile attribution bias the mean value and standard deviation is 3.47 and 0.86 respectively. According to the correlations table all study variables are positively correlated with each other at significance level less than 99 percent.

Table 2***Mean standard deviation and correlations***

	Mean	SD	HAB	TI	POP	CWB	WO
HAB	3.47	0.86	1				
TI	3.30	1.02	.620**	1			
POP	3.67	0.95	.547**	.721**	1		
CWB	3.81	1.35	.570**	.472**	.664**	1	
WO	4.67	1.37	.453**	.610**	.757**	.700**	1

Note: ** Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

POP=perception of politics, WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

4.4 Evaluation of the Measurement Model

Measurement model was assessed before moving to the structural model to analyze the structural model for hypothesis testing. First reliability and validity of the constructs was established to check if the model can further take on for the hypotheses testing. The measurement model includes five variables and items ranging from three to nineteen. Measurement model includes two steps: first it establishes the item's reliability for all variables through composite reliability (CR), average variance extracted (AVE) and individual indicator reliability with the Cronbach's alpha in order to further assess the convergent and discriminant validity. In the end multicollinearity was also assessed through checking variance of inflation (VIF) for every individual variable.

4.4.1 Internal Consistency Reliability

To measure the internal consistency reliability of the instruments used in the study alpha values and composite reliability (CR) is assessed. To measure consistency between items and appropriateness of all items of a construct that depicts that all items measure the same construct CR is calculated. Threshold value for CR for each construct is 0.7 and above. Table 3 shows the CR of all constructs is greater than 0.7 and ranges from 0.844 to 0.972. Furthermore, alpha values of the construct range from 0.855 to 0.972 which shows that all scales are reliable to use in the current study. These findings indicate that the construct items have excellent internal consistency and reliability.

4.4.2 Convergent Validity

To assess the convergent validity is inter-relation between all items of the individual construct is taken into consideration. It further describes that all items converging together measure the same construct. Therefore, convergent validity is based on the idea that all items of a single construct together will measure the same thing (Henseler, Ringle, & Sinkovics, 2009). For this purpose, variance of all items is measured through Average variance extracted (AVE) method. The value of AVE should be greater than 0.5 or above. Results of convergent validity are presented in table 3 under the heading of AVE. The value of AVE ranges from 0.58 to 0.77 for all the variables of the study.

Table 3***Cronbach's alpha, CR, AVE***

	Cronbach's alpha	rho_A	CR	AVE
CWB	0.972	0.972	0.974	0.666
HAB	0.858	0.861	0.894	0.585
POP	0.959	0.960	0.964	0.690
TI	0.855	0.855	0.912	0.776
WO	0.956	0.957	0.962	0.715

Note: POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias, AVE=average variance extracted, CR=Composite Reliability

4.3.3 Item Loadings

Table 4-8 shows item loadings for all the constructs. In order to evaluate how well an item contributes to a factor, it is crucial to assess the factor loadings for all the constructs. Measurement model performs the confirmatory factor analysis which determines whether the items adequately describe the particular factor or not. Through factor loadings all items are measured, according to the rule of thumb, 0.7 and higher values of item loadings indicate good reliability. Moreover, higher loadings depict that all the items have much in common that

represent a single construct. In some studies items with low to moderate loadings ranging from 0.4 - 0.7 are considered for removal. Items below the value of 0.7 are carefully considered and removed only if doing so will aid in increasing the values of CR and AVE to reach the minimum threshold (Chin, 2010; Joseph F. Hair Jr, Hult, Ringle, & Sarstedt, 2016). Items with very low loadings in case of 0.4 and below are deleted as it will be a threat to construct reliability and validity.

Table 4

Item loadings for CWB

Construct Name	Items	Loadings
CWB	CWB1	0.798
	CWB10	0.826
	CWB11	0.78
	CWB12	0.84
	CWB13	0.797
	CWB14	0.847
	CWB15	0.833
	CWB16	0.832
	CWB17	0.854
	CWB18	0.831
	CWB19	0.808
	CWB2	0.764
	CWB3	0.821
	CWB4	0.784
	CWB5	0.816
	CWB6	0.823
	CWB7	0.826
	CWB8	0.809
	CWB9	0.815

Note: CWB=Counterproductive Work Behavior

Table 4 shows factor loadings for counterproductive behavior (CWB) all items have loadings above the threshold value of 0.7. The minimum factor loads at 0.74 and highest factor loads at 0.85. As all item loadings are within specified range thus no item in this scale was deleted for further analysis.

Table 5

Items loading for Hostile Attribution Bias

Construct Name	Items	Loadings
Hostile Attribution Bias	HAB1	0.793
	HAB2	0.79
	HAB3	0.745
	HAB4	0.788
	HAB5	0.78
	HAB6	0.689

Note: HAB=Hostile Attribution Bias

Table 5 shows factor loadings for hostile attribution bias (HAB) all items have loadings above the threshold value of 0.7 except HAB6 having loading value of 0.689 which is close to 0.7. As the only item with loading below 0.7 in this scale doesn't affect the reliability and validity of the scale, hence the item was not deleted. The minimum factor loads at 0.689 and highest factor loads at 0.78, all item loadings are within specified range, thus no item in this scale was deleted for further analysis.

Table 6***Items loading for POP***

Construct Name	Items	Loadings
POP	POP1	0.84
	POP10	0.847
	POP11	0.81
	POP12	0.838
	POP2	0.85
	POP3	0.851
	POP4	0.854
	POP5	0.836
	POP6	0.812
	POP7	0.798
	POP8	0.835
	POP9	0.796

Note: POP=Perceptions of Organizational Politics

Table 6 shows factor loadings for perceptions of organizational politics (POP) all items have loadings above the threshold value of 0.7. The minimum factor loads at 0.79 and highest factor loads at 0.84. As all item loadings are within specified range thus no item in this scale was deleted for further analysis.

Table 7***Item loadings for turnover intention***

Construct Name	Items	Loadings
Turnover Intention	TI1	0.881
	TI2	0.869
	TI3	0.892

Note: TI= Turnover Intention

Table 7 shows factor loadings for turnover intention (TI) all items have loadings above the threshold value of 0.7. The minimum factor loads at 0.86 and highest factor loads at 0.89. As all item loadings are within specified range thus no item in this scale was deleted for further analysis.

Table 8

Item loading for workplace ostracism

Construct Name	Items	Loadings
Workplace Ostracism	WO1	0.826
	WO10	0.804
	WO2	0.885
	WO3	0.86
	WO4	0.86
	WO5	0.823
	WO6	0.851
	WO7	0.842
	WO8	0.866
	WO9	0.838

Note: WO= Workplace Ostracism

Table 8 shows factor loadings for workplace ostracism (WO) all items have loadings above the threshold value of 0.7. The minimum factor loads at 0.80 and highest factor loads at 0.88. As all item loadings are within specified range thus no item in this scale was deleted for further analysis.

4.4.5 Discriminant Validity

Discriminatory validity assesses the distinction between all the constructs for a particular study. Cross Loadings and Fornell Lacker were previously used in most of the studies that use Smart PLS for data analysis. Currently Heterotrait-Mono Trait (HTMT) ratios are frequently used as

more robust technique together with the old methods to assess the discriminant validity of the constructs.

4.4.5.1 Formell Lacker Method

Formell Lacker method considers the square root of AVE of the constructs. If the square root of AVE of a construct is placed in the diagonal of a matrix, it should be highest from the correlation of all other constructs. This ensures the validity of that construct (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016; Henseler et al., 2009). Table 9 displays that the square root of AVE for POP is 0.831, which is highest in value of correlation than all other constructs. Hence, POP fulfills the criteria of discriminant validity. Similarly, square root of AVE for workplace ostracism is 0.846, which is highest in value of maximum correlation of workplace ostracism with any other construct. Hence, it can be concluded that workplace ostracism possesses discriminant validity. Square root of AVE value for turnover intention is 0.881, which is highest in value of maximum correlation of turnover intention with any other construct. Hence, it could be determined that turnover intention possesses discriminant validity. Square root of AVE for CWB is 0.816, which is the highest in value of maximum correlation of CWB with any other construct. Hence, it can be decided that CWB possesses discriminant validity. Square root of AVE for hostile attribution bias is 0.765, which is highest in value of maximum correlation of hostile attribution bias with any other construct. Hence, it can be established that hostile attribution bias possesses discriminant validity.

Table 9***Fornell Lacker***

	CWB	HAB	POP	TI	WO
CWB	0.816				
HAB	0.581	0.765			
POP	0.667	0.566	0.831		
TI	0.476	0.637	0.723	0.881	
WO	0.702	0.473	0.759	0.612	0.846

Note: Bold values present square root of Average Variance Extracted (AVE), POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

4.4.5.2 HTMT

Recent research studies have proposed that neither the cross-loadings nor the evaluation of the Fornell-Lacker criterion fully determines the discriminant validity (Henseler, Ringle, & Sarstedt, 2015). Instead, the researchers have proposed the heterotrait-monotrait ratio (HTMT) (Henseler et al., 2015) as an alternative for discriminant validity measure, though all three methods are used in alternatives of each other and in some cases together to assess the discriminant validity. HTMT ratio is calculated on the average of the correlations of indicators across constructs measuring various phenomena, further it makes comparison with the average of the correlations of indicators of the same construct as well. The values of the HTMT ratio should be below 0.85 to decide discriminant validity (Henseler et al., 2015). The results displayed in Table 10 indicate that the HTMT criterion was met as all values are below the cutoff value.

Table 10***HTMT***

	CWB	HAB	POP	TI	WO
CWB					
HAB	0.635				
POP	0.689	0.621			
TI	0.521	0.741	0.797		
WO	0.727	0.522	0.791	0.674	

Note: POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism. TI=turnover intention, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

4.4.5.3 Cross Loadings

The third method to check discriminant validity is to analyze the cross loadings. If all the factor loadings of one construct are loaded in the same construct and values of the items are higher in its own construct from the factor loadings of the same construct across loadings in all other constructs of the study, this ensures discriminant validity for that construct. The cross loadings for all five constructs loaded across all constructs is shown in Appendix B. Results show that all factors are highest in loading when they are loaded in their own relative construct.

4.4.6 Multicollinearity of the data

Another important aspect to check before measuring the structural model is to analyze the multicollinearity in the data (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016). In Smart PLS multicollinearity is checked through variance of inflation factor (VIF). The value for VIF should not exceed 10 and

value below 5 is good. However some researchers have given a cutoff value of 3.3 for VIF (Kock & Lynn, 2012). All five study variables have VIF less than 3.3 which ensures that the data is free of multicollinearity and the structural model can be calculated and analyzed for hypothesis testing. Table 11 shows the values of all variables of the study checked for multicollinearity issue.

Table 11

VIF

	VIF
CWB	2.096
HAB	1.146
POP	2.176
TI	1.351
WO	2.611

VIF=variance inflation factor, CWB=counterproductive behavior, POP= perceptions of organizational politics, TI=turnover intention, WO=workplace ostracism. HAB=hostile attribution bias

All conditions for data reliability and validity are met which indicates that the study variables are satisfactory to run in the structural model to test the hypotheses and define the causal relationships.

4.5 Quality of the Structural Model

In Smart PLS the quality of the structural model is determined through applying different measures that together determine whether the structural model has measured substantial results or not.

4.5.1 Coefficient of Determination

It is preferred to measure the coefficient of determination (R^2) of the path model to estimate the change that all independent variables of a model are causing in the dependent variable (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016). Value of R^2 is analyzed as 0.2 or less as low, 0.13 Or above as moderate and 0.27 and high is substantial which is more desirable (J. Cohen, 1988). The results in table 12 shows that POP and workplace ostracism have a significant impact on CWB as the R^2 value is 0.594 which is above 0.27. POP and workplace ostracism also have a significant impact on employee turnover intentions as the change representing the R^2 value is 0.616 which is above the value of 0.27. The impact of POP on mediating variables is significant as it causes 0.575 changes in workplace ostracism and the value is above the threshold value of 0.27. R^2 value represents that the independent variable is causing 50 percent change in the dependent variable on average which adds to the quality of the structural model. R^2 values are presented in table 12.

4.5.2 Effect Size

After Evaluating the coefficient of determination for all the dependent variables next step is to assess the effect size (f^2) to investigate the substantial effect of independent variable on the dependent variable the independent variable is first omitted from the model and the R^2 value is analyzed. After that the independent variable is added to check if the presence of the independent variable has a strong or weak effect on the measurement of the dependent variable. The f^2 is

assessed in three levels if the value of f is 0.02 and less it means a low effect of the independent variable on the dependent variable. If the f^2 value is 0.15 and above it means the independent variable has a moderate impact on the dependent variable. If the f^2 value is 0.35 and above it means the independent variable has a large effect on the dependent variable (J. Cohen, 1988). However, the researchers suggest that even the smallest value of f^2 should not be ignored as it may have unique insights into the relationship between independent and the dependent variable (Chin, Marcolin, & Newsted, 2003). Table 12 shows results for the f^2 values. The results indicate that all the direct relationships in the model have low to moderate effect size, except the direct relationship between workplace ostracism and turnover intention which has a very low f^2 value of 0.014.

4.5.3 Predictive relevance

The next step is to evaluate the predictive relevance (q^2) which is measured through Stone-Geisser principle. The value of q^2 not only measures the predictive value of independent variable for the dependent variable, it also provides added valuation of the inner paths of the structural model (Henseler et al., 2009). To evaluate the predictive relevance q^2 the Smart PLS performs the measurement by blindfolding method (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016; Henseler et al., 2009). Therefore, the present study used the Stone-Geisser test to assess the predictive ability, through blindfolding procedure which provides measurement for the cross-validated redundancy for dependent variables (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016). Q values should be greater than zero for the study to have predictive relevance through its independent variables in the model. The results in Table 12 show that all the q^2 values are above the threshold value which is larger than zero (0.123). The results for q^2 further recommend that the model has considerable predictive relevance.

Table 12***Values of R^2 f^2 q^2***

	f^2	R^2	q^2
POP -> TI	0.152	0.616	0.469
POP -> CWB	0.042	0.594	0.39
POP -> WO	0.1359	0.576	0.408
WO -> TI	0.014		
WO -> CWB	0.197		

Note: POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

4.5.4 Goodness of Fit

There is a debate on the validation of single global goodness of fit (gof) measure for PLS-SEM models. Some researchers accept it as an adequate measure for gof Tenenhaus, Amato, & Esposito Vinzi, (2004) and some others researchers question the validity of gof available for PLS-SEM models.(Hair Jr et al., 2016) Therefore the quality of the structural model is assessed by measuring R^2 , f^2 and q^2 value which represents a better picture for validating the structural model in PLS-SEM.

It focuses on two measures, one is the standardized root mean square residual (SRMR) and the other is NFI. The value of SRMR should be less than 0.08 and the value of normal fit

index (NFI) is acceptable when it is closer to 1 (Byrne, 2013). Table 13 shows that the model has the value of SRMR (0.038) in acceptable range and the value of NFI (0.86) is approaching 1 which is not the perfect fit though it represents a good fit.

Table 13

Model Fit

	Saturated Model	Estimated Model
SRMR	0.036	0.038
d_ULS	1.618	1.839
d_G	1.202	1.217
Chi-Square	2016.294	2022.286
NFI	0.866	0.866

4.6 Measurement of the Structural Model

After examining the satisfactory factor loadings, reliability and validity of the data and constructs through the measurement model, the next step is to establish a structural model for testing the hypotheses of the present study.

4.6.1 Direct Relationships

First the inner model was analyzed to assess the direct relationships between the study variables. In simple words direct relationship between independent and dependent variables was examined to test the hypotheses 1 and 2. Furthermore, direct relationship of POP and mediating variables was checked to test hypotheses 3. Direct relationship of mediating variables and dependent variables is examined through testing hypothesis 4 and 5. All direct relationships were tested for path model first, though path model gives the coefficient values, however, it doesn't show the significance through p-values. The current study has used the bootstrapping method in Smart PLS 3.0., to test significance of relationships in direct paths. As recommended by researchers 5000 resample are used for the Bootstrapping model that was applied in the current study, (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016; Henseler et al., 2009). Figure 2 shows the bootstrapping model with all direct path coefficients and significance values.

Table 14 shows that the beta coefficient value for direct positive relation of POP with CWB is 0.22 having a t-value of 3.602. T-value for this relationship is significant at $p < 0.01$ which indicates that POP has a significant relationship with CWB. Hence, hypothesis 1 is accepted. It is concluded that POP has a positive significant relationship with CWB which confirms the proposed relationship in hypothesis 1.

Table 14 shows that the beta coefficient value for direct positive relation of POP with turnover intention is 0.407 having a t-value of 6.401. T-value for this relationship is significant at $p < 0.01$ which indicates that POP has a significant direct relationship with turnover intention. Hence, hypothesis 2 is accepted. It is concluded that POP has a positive significant relationship with turnover intention which confirms the proposed relationship in hypothesis 2.

Table 14 shows that the beta coefficient value for direct positive relation of POP with workplace ostracism is 0.757 having a t-value of 27.645. T-value for this relationship is significant at $p < 0.01$ which indicates that POP has a significant direct relationship with workplace ostracism. Hence, hypothesis 3 is accepted. It is concluded that POP has a positive significant relationship with workplace ostracism which confirms the proposed relationship in hypothesis 3.

Table 14 shows that the beta coefficient value for direct positive relation of workplace ostracism with CWB is 0.439 having a t-value of 6.973. T-value for this relationship is significant at $p < 0.01$ which indicates that workplace ostracism has a significant direct relationship with CWB. Hence, hypothesis 4 is accepted. It is concluded that workplace ostracism has a positive significant relationship with CWB which confirms the proposed relationship in hypothesis 4.

Table 14 shows that the beta coefficient value for direct positive relation of workplace ostracism with CWB is 0.113 having a t-value of 2.11. T-value for this relationship is significant at $p < 0.05$ which indicates that workplace ostracism has a significant direct relationship with turnover intention. Hence, hypothesis 5 is accepted. It is concluded that workplace ostracism has a positive significant relationship with turnover intention which confirms the proposed relationship in hypothesis 5.

Table 14***Direct paths***

	Beta	Mean	SD	t-value	p-value
POP -> TI	0.407	0.41	0.064	6.401	0.000
POP -> CWB	0.22	0.221	0.061	3.602	0.000
POP -> WO	0.757	0.756	0.027	27.645	0.000
WO -> TI	0.113	0.11	0.053	2.11	0.035
WO -> CWB	0.439	0.44	0.063	6.973	0.000

Note: POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

4.6.2 Mediation Testing

The proposed research model also includes the role of workplace ostracism as the potential mediator between POP and two employee outcomes for the current study. One mediating effect of workplace ostracism is examined on the relationship between POP and CWB. The second mediating effect of workplace ostracism is tested on the relationship between POP and turnover intention. Furthermore, to test the mediating effects the guidelines are considered provided by Hair et al. (2017) and other previous research studies that are conducted with Smart PLS.

The method for the mediation analysis is based first calculating the path coefficients together with standard errors of the direct path between two direct relationships: one is the direct

relationship between independent variable (POP) and the mediating variable (workplace ostracism), other is the direct relationship between mediating variable (workplace ostracism) and dependent variable (CWB/turnover intention). Hence, the extent to which workplace ostracism mediates the relationship between POP and dependent variables is determined by examining the results of the PLS direct path analysis.

Considering the product of the standardized paths between POP-workplace ostracism and workplace ostracism-CWB yields the indirect effect of POP on CWB mediated by workplace ostracism (Joe F. Hair Jr, Matthews, Matthews, & Sarstedt, 2017; Wamba et al., 2017). As the current study has two dependent variables, the same process will be performed for the mediating effect of workplace ostracism on the relationship between POP and turnover intention. Following Hair et al. (2017), the bootstrapping model with 5000 re-samples was used to test for the mediating effects that take into consideration the significance of the two indirect effects.

According to the results (table 15) of the bootstrapping, the indirect effect of POP on CWB (0.331) is significant at $p < 0.001$. This concludes that workplace ostracism has a complementary partial mediation effect on the relationship between POP and CWB. Hence, hypothesis 6 is accepted that confirms the proposed mediation effect of workplace ostracism. Further, the total of direct and indirect effects constituting the total effect are also significant (0.553) at $p < 0.01$ for POP and CWB.

The indirect effect of POP on turnover intention (0.084) is significant at $p < 0.05$. This concludes that workplace ostracism has a complementary partial mediation effect on the relationship between POP and CWB. Hence, hypothesis 7 is accepted that confirms the proposed mediation effect of workplace ostracism. Further, the total of direct and indirect effects shown in

table 15, constituting the total effect are also significant (0.495) at $p < 0.01$ for POP and turnover intention.

Table 15

Indirect effects and Total effects

		Beta	Mean	SD	t-value	p-value
Indirect effects	POP -> WO -> TI	0.084	0.084	0.041	2.078	0.038
	POP-> WO -> CWB	0.331	0.333	0.052	6.371	0.000
Total effects	POP-> CWB	0.553	0.557	0.053	10.427	0.000
	POP -> TI	0.495	0.496	0.052	9.57	0.000

Note: POP=perceptions of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism, TI=turnover intention, CWB= counterproductive work behavior

4.6.3 Moderated Mediation

The role of a moderating variable is to act as an independent variable that affects the strength of the relationship in either positive or negative ways. For testing the moderating effect, first through PLS algorithm path model the effect of independent variable on dependent variable is assessed. Significant relationship between independent and dependent variable is the base to check the moderating effect of a third independent variable. The next step is to analyze the effect

of independent and moderating variables collectively on the dependent variable. The interaction term is the product of independent variables and the moderating variable, if the interaction term is significant it will conclude that there is moderation between the two independent and dependent variables (Joseph F. Hair Jr et al., 2016).

The current study uses the above-mentioned procedure for checking the moderating effects of hostile attribution bias on the relationship between workplace ostracism and CWB. The second moderation effect will be checked on workplace ostracism and turnover intention.

Table 16 shows interaction term for CWB is significant (0.06) at $p < 0.05$, the beta value shows no negative sign which indicates that the moderating effect is positive which strengthens the positive relation between workplace ostracism and turnover intention. As hypothesis 8 proposes that high hostile attribution bias positively moderates the relationship between workplace ostracism and CWB, hence the results conclude that the proposed hypothesis 8 is accepted.

Table 16 shows interaction term for Turnover intention is significant (-0.119) at $p < 0.01$, the beta value shows a negative sign which indicates that the moderating effect is negative which weakens the positive relation between workplace ostracism and turnover intention. As hypothesis 9 proposes that high hostile attribution bias positively moderates the relationship between workplace ostracism and turnover intention, hence the results conclude that the proposed hypothesis 9 is not accepted.

Table 16***Interaction term results***

	Beta	Mean	SD	t-value	p-value
HAB x WO -> TI	-0.119	-0.119	0.038	3.133	0.002
HAB x WO -> CWB	0.106	0.105	0.046	2.295	0.022

Note: WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

To check the conditional indirect effects the current study uses SPSS Process as the index of moderation is the indicator of significant moderating mediating effects. Furthermore, to assess conditional effects at different levels of moderators, the process by Hayes provides slope analysis as well to interpret the results better.

Table 17 shows the significant indirect relationship between POP and CWB conditional at different levels of moderator which is hostile attribution bias. The index of moderated mediation is significant (0.135) as the upper and lower confidence intervals contain no zero and there is no negative sign which indicates that hostile attribution bias positively moderates the indirect relationship between POP and CWB. Hostile attribution bias at high level strengthens the indirect effect which is in support of the stated hypothesis 10. Thus, the results conclude that hypothesis 10 is accepted. Furthermore, the graph in figure 4.1 shows simple slopes for the

conditional indirect at different levels of moderator. The high attribution bias slope at plus one standard deviation is displayed with green color. The slope is steeper and above the lower hostile attribution slope at minus one standard deviation displayed with blue color which means that at higher moderation levels the indirect effect between POP and CWB through workplace ostracism increases. The slopes showed indirect relationship between POP and CWB strengthened at high level of moderator and weakened at low level of moderator. The results for moderated mediation are also confirmed through the graphical presentation of the slopes.

Table 18 shows the significant indirect relationship between POP and Turnover conditional at different levels of moderator which is hostile attribution bias. The index of moderated mediation is significant (-1.06) as the upper and lower confidence intervals contain no zero and the negative sign indicates that hostile attribution bias negatively moderates the indirect relationship between POP and turnover intention. Hostile attribution bias at high level weakens or decreases the indirect effect which is against the stated hypothesis 11. Thus, the results conclude that hypothesis 11 is not accepted. Furthermore, the graph in figure 4.2 shows simple slopes for the conditional indirect at different levels of moderator. The high attribution bias slope at plus one standard deviation is showed with green color and is flat which means that at higher moderation level the indirect effect between POP and turnover intention through workplace ostracism does not increase as proposed in the hypothesis 11. Furthermore at minus one standard deviation a steeper slope is shown with blue color which is contrary to the proposed relationship that at low level of hostile attribution bias the Indirect relationship will be weaken between POP and turnover intention. The results for moderated mediation are also confirmed through the graphical presentation of the slopes.

Table 17***Conditional indirect effects (POP -> WO ->CWB)***

POP -> WO ->CWB	Indirect effect	SE	LLCI	ULCI
HAB at -1 SD (-8.75)	0.359	0.087	0.202	0.42
HAB at Mean (.000)	0.474	0.044	0.332	0.633
HAB at + SD (+8.75)	0.59	0.097	0.405	0.783
Index of moderated mediation	Index	SE	LLCI	ULCI
HAB	0.135	0.06	0.011	0.244

Note: POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism. CWB=counterwork productive behavior, HAB=hostile attribution bias

Table 18***Conditional indirect effects (POP -> WO ->TI)***

POP -> WO ->TI	Indirect effect	SE	LLCI	ULCI
HAB at -1 SD (-8.75)	0.186	0.048	0.09	0.282
HAB at Mean (.000)	0.095	0.044	0.009	0.182
HAB at +1 SD (.875)	0.004	0.059	-0.115	0.117
Index of moderated mediation	Index	SE	LLCI	ULCI
HAB	-1.06	0.37	-1.81	-0.37

Note: POP=perception of organizational politics, WO=workplace ostracism. TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias

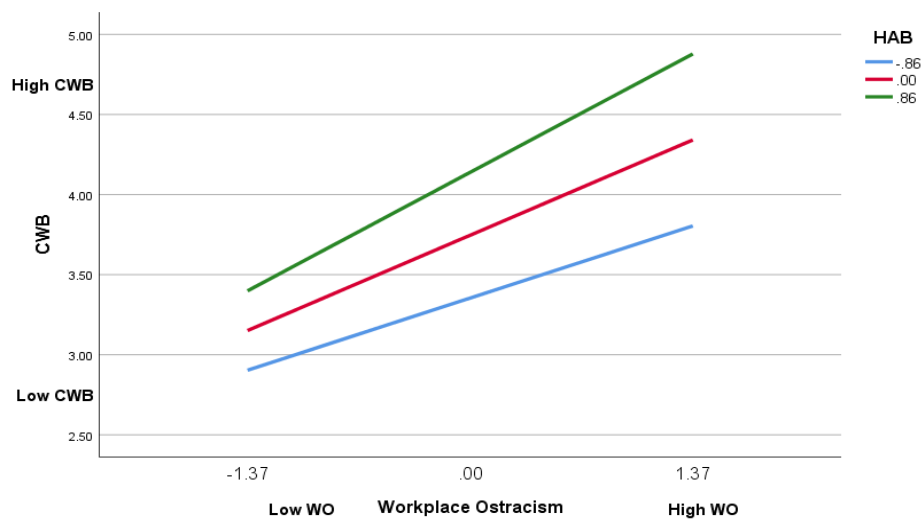


Figure 4.1

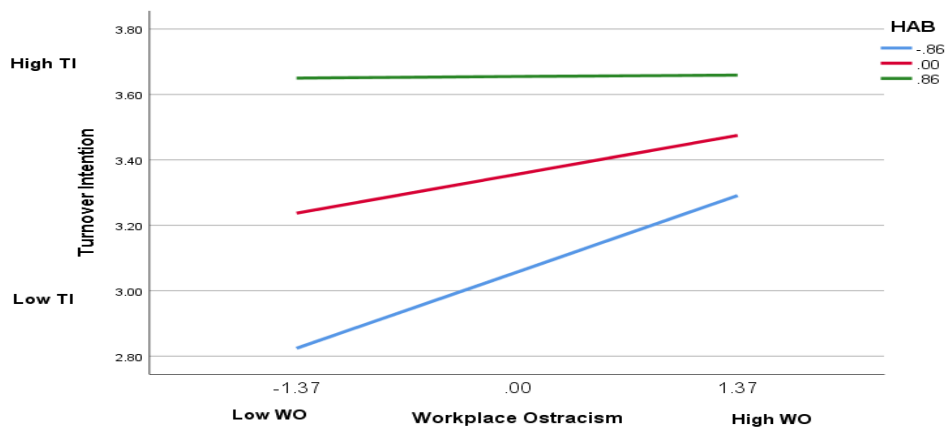


Figure 4.2

4.7 Chapter Summary

This chapter included results of the proposed hypotheses of the study obtained from data analysis methods; it further gives information on the descriptive statistics and correlation analysis. The findings reveal that from total 11 hypotheses 9 were accepted in the proposed direction with full support, however, 2 hypotheses were rejected that provide further insight for future research. Moreover, the chapter offers results from the measurement model that further confirms the reliability and validity for the scales used in the current study. In addition to the measurement model and structural model results substantial values of R^2 , f^2 and q^2 validated the quality of theoretical framework of the study.

CHAPTER 5

DISCUSSION, FUTURE RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

5.1 Chapter Overview

The final chapter includes pertinent findings of the study on hand. It discusses the significant positive and negative results reported in the previous chapter of the study. It will further discuss the support of results from previous research studies and will make efforts to elaborate the inconsistencies. In view of both theoretical and managerial implications, particularly in the context of the private sector of Pakistan, insightful findings are discussed, along with providing future directions to the researchers for furthering research on the literature of POP.

5.2 Interpretation of Direct Paths

Social exchange theory provides a theoretical explanation of positive association between POP and employee CWB (Crawford et al., 2019). When employees feel that they are not being treated fair in the exchange relationship they tend to show deviant behaviors which supports the idea of H1 in current research study. Furthermore, the impact of POP on CWB suggests that organizations where employees experience political atmosphere and injustice are more likely to display CWB, which emphasizes the importance of creating an environment of justice. Furthermore, the results are consistent with some past research studies where a positive association could be seen between POP and CWB (Meisler et al., 2019; Zettler & Hilbig, 2010). Research study conducted by Kaur & Kang (2022) also revealed that POP results in increased deviant behavior such as knowledge hiding further reducing discretionary positive behaviors of

employees. The results of H1 are supported and thus it can be stated that, POP in the private sector of Pakistan tends to have a positive significant impact on the CWB.

POP and turnover intention is positively associated with each other according to hypothesis 2 of the current study. Political perceptions have the elements of uncertainty and unfairness which can cause employees feelings of stress (Ali et al., 2021) and anxiety (Haider et al., 2020) at their workplace which reduces their motivation at work. Thus, employees who have negative perceptions regarding the political environment of the workplace might plan to leave their current jobs in order to find new jobs where the work environment is less political and free of stress so they can work in a healthy environment (Clercq et al., 2021). Furthermore, past studies have evidence of POP positively associated with employee turnover intentions that support the hypothesis developed and tested in the current study, social exchange theory provides in depth understanding for employees leaving their organization where policies are made and applied through a political system (C. Chang et al., 2009). The results of hypothesis 2 are supported and validated in the light of previous research that explains how political perceptions of employees build intentions of employees to leave their current jobs.

The current study found a positive association between workplace ostracism and CWB. The results are consistent with the findings of the past studies that have already discussed that ostracized employees are more prone to feel like outsiders, which makes them less likely to engage in positive behaviors including helping their colleagues instead they develop more propensity for workplace deviant behaviors (Chung, 2017). In another study related to services sector employees, workplace ostracism was tested as positively related to employee's knowledge hiding behavior (Zhao et al., 2016). Furthermore, workplace ostracism is a threat to positive interpersonal relationships, employees who are not treated well by their organization and co-

workers will be encouraged to react with the same negativity that is well explained under social exchange theory (Fatima, 2016). The results of H3 are supported and thus it can be stated that, workplace ostracism in the private sector of Pakistan tends to have a positive significant impact on the CWB.

Ostracism in the workplace is a prevalent phenomenon that affects every sector of economy. Although in some situations it may be thought of as some mild activities, still it poses a negative impact on people and their social connections (Wu et al., 2012). The current study found a positive association between workplace ostracism and employee turnover intention. Previous studies have explained it as a stressful situation for employees that at a certain level ostracized employees feel burnout which makes them develop negative feelings towards their organization (Farasat et al., 2021). To protect themselves against emotional exhaustion, employees try to avoid the situation of workplace ostracism which leads to turnover intention. The results of H4 are consistent with the findings of previous research which define workplace ostracism as a potential predictor of employee turnover intention, furthermore, under social exchange theory employees feel that the social exchange relationship is compromised that increases employees intentions to quit their jobs (Ngo-Henha, 2018).

The degree to which an employee perceives the workplace as having a self-serving culture is known as political perception (Cho & Yang, 2018). Employee perceptions can become a major cause of nourishing social stressors at the workplace. Hypothesis 5 was developed to assess the positive relation of POP in organization with workplace ostracism. Results show a significant relation of POP with workplace ostracism that is based on the model presented by previous research studies (D. Karim, 2021). POP creates a sense of imbalance in social exchange relationships, for the purpose of enhancing and promoting self-interest; employees might ignore

their coworkers or exclude them from important meetings and decision-making processes. Social exchange theory supports the idea of POP leading to workplace ostracism which is also supported by the previous studies on POP leading to workplace ostracism (D. Karim, 2021; D. N. Karim et al., 2021). In light of the literature review on POP and workplace ostracism the results of hypothesis 5 are validated.

5.3 Interpretation of Mediating Results

Literature has discussed the mediating role of workplace ostracism in the relationship between abusive supervision and unproductive behavior on the basis of this model the current study has extended the research by testing the mediating role of workplace ostracism between POP and employee outcomes (CWB and turnover intention).

Workplace ostracism is tested as the mediator between POP and CWB as proposed by hypothesis 6 in the current study. The results indicated that the indirect effect of POP on CWB was significant after adding the mediator which supports partial mediation. Results were supported by the previous research, POP creates an environment for workplace ostracism (D. Karim, 2021), that consequently increases counterproductive behaviors of the employees (Yang & Treadway, 2018).

Hypothesis 7 proposed that workplace ostracism moderates the relationship between POP and turnover intention. POP creates an environment of interpersonal distrust which leads to tension among interpersonal relationships (D. N. Karim et al., 2021). Workplace ostracism predicted by POP develops employee intentions to leave the organization (Farasat et al., 2021) which results in acceptance of hypothesis 7. As the effect of POP on turnover intention is not completely eliminated by adding workplace ostracism to the relationship this shows that there is partial mediation.

As the mediating role of workplace ostracism is defined for the first time in the relationship between POP and employee outcomes, it enriches the literature on understanding how employee perceptions of organizational politics cause negative workplace outcomes.

5.4 Interpretation of Moderating Results

The study has established a moderated mediation model for the current study which involves testing the conditional direct effects and conditional indirect effects.

5.4.1 Conditional Direct effects

Hostile attribution bias serves as the moderator in the relationship between workplace ostracism and CWB. The results of the hypothesis 8 were consistent with previous research studies that address employees who have high hostile attribution bias tend to be more aggressive (Klein Tuate et al., 2019). When employees attribute the behaviors of others as hostile without being aware of their actual intention, they consequently get emotionally exhausted and retaliate with unethical and deviant behaviors. The evidence from literature explains that moderating the role of hostile attribution has strengthened the positive impact of workplace ostracism on emotional exhaustion (Qi et al., 2020) Furthermore, employees with high hostile attribution bias may take revenge for the uncivil behaviors of others by increasing deviant behaviors towards them who have treated them in uncivil ways (Wu et al., 2014). Thus, in the case of current study when employees experience ostracism they consequently react in counterproductive ways and hostile attribution bias acts as the catalyst in their relationship by increasing the magnitude of positive direct relationship on CWB.

Hypothesis 9 proposes that the direct relationship between workplace ostracism and turnover intention is positively moderated by hostile attribution bias. However, the proposed relationship was not supported in the current study. Hostile attribution bias was negatively

moderating the said relationship, as with the increase of workplace ostracism turnover intentions were also increased but hostile attribution was not found to be increasing at the same level. One reason could be that employees' hostile attribution bias is not much significant in the relationship between workplace ostracism and turnover intention, as employees might already judge the reason behind ostracism (Milich & Dodge, 1984) and accept it as the culture of their organization. As the moderating role of hostile attribution bias is not tested before on the relationship between workplace ostracism and turnover intention the results of the current study will be a great contribution for the literature on hostile attribution bias.

5.4.2 Conditional Indirect effects

The quantitative results revealed that hypothesis 10 testing the boundary condition on the mediated relationship between POP and CWB was accepted. The results are consistent with the findings of previous literature that employees with biases in attribution style tend to blame others (Adams & John, 1997), even for their own wrongdoings and find it hard to admit their own mistake (Chabrol et al., 2009). The analysis furthers our understanding on the role of hostile attribution bias as the moderator in the study. It explained the critical role of attributions in determining employee perceptions and shaping behaviors of employees at the workplace. The results demonstrated that the negative attributions block the view of employees that result in making judgments and ignoring the reality. Respondents reported a high hostile attribution bias that speaks about the biased thinking styles and attributions that clearly impact the perceptions of an individual. Results for hypothesis 10 find consistencies with the previous findings where hostile attribution bias buffers the indirect effects positively between ostracism and unethical employee behavior via emotional exhaustion (Qi et al., 2020). Extending research on previous findings hypothesis 10 was supported.

The empirical investigation revealed that hypothesis 11 testing the boundary condition on the mediated relationship between POP and turnover intention was rejected. One reason for the failure of acceptance of hypothesis 11 might be the acceptance of hypothesis 10. When employees perceive their workplaces having unfair and unjust practices and procedures which is further hampering the positive interpersonal relationships at the workplace in the shape of workplace ostracism, they might refuse to become a victim. Instead of planning to quit their jobs they retaliate by practicing deviant and unproductive behaviors. Another reason is that hostile attribution bias might need some other moderating variable such as negative reciprocity beliefs to have a combined effect on the indirect relationship (Wu et al., 2014) between POP and turnover intention via workplace ostracism.

5.5 Theoretical Implications

The focus of current study is to develop and empirically test a theoretical relationship between several variables based on social exchange theory. More specifically, it provides details on the mediation effect of workplace ostracism in the relationship between POP and employees' turnover intention and CWB in the private sector of Pakistan. A total of 11 hypotheses were established out of which 9 hypotheses are fully supported and 2 hypotheses failed to conform to the proposed relationships.

Previous researchers have found a number of factors that could affect employee workplace outcomes. However, the integration of political perceptions of employees and workplace ostracism in organization has received little attention. Based on this assumption, the structural association between political perceptions in organization as predictor of social stressor resulting in CWB and turnover intention is examined in a single model.

The theory of social exchange suggests that exchange relationships are based on mutual trust and assumptions of fairness. However, POP develops an atmosphere of uncertainty, unfair procedures and self-serving behaviors that employees feel obligated to return negative behaviors and attitudes in balancing the negative exchange relationship. Moreover, the mediator of the study adds significant contributions in understanding the exchange relationships, when employees are motivated to practice self-serving behaviors; they tend to socially marginalize others. The role of workplace ostracism as a mediator contributes to the model of study by defining the process through which POP and negative employee outcomes operate in an organization.

The study adds further insight on the importance of employees' attribution bias based on theory of social exchange in predicting employee outcomes. This study also contributes in theory by introducing the moderating role of hostile attribution bias, which is supposed to exacerbate the negative effect of POP and workplace ostracism on employee outcomes. Employees with high hostile attribution bias are supposed to assume firm perceptions about politics in organization. Furthermore, if they feel that their coworkers are involved in political maneuvering and have some influence over organizational decisions then hostile attributions intensify the negative exchange relationships.

The findings of current study provide substantial empirical support to the framework based on the theory of social exchange. Therefore, the structural model of the study adds empirically to the theory and provides support for the theory's assumptions.

5.6 Managerial Implications

The current research is useful from a managerial and organizational perspective. It offers important insights into how employee perceptions regarding organizational politics influence the

employees' attitudinal and behavioral response patterns, adversely affecting employee relationships with its organization.

The proposed model emphasizes how employees view relationships with their organizations and coworkers, assisting HR managers and practitioners in utilizing human resources to the fullest potential and producing collaborating work that results in synergy. A significant implication for the managers in this study is that if they treat their coworkers or subordinates with callous disregard, it will strengthen their perceptions of ostracism. Employees as victims of ostracism might develop an emotionally depleted state resulting in undesirable job outcomes.

To improve employee performance and reduce unproductive work behaviors, a dynamic organizational environment should emphasize on utilizing employees' social exchange interactions at work and preventing employees' unfavorable perceptions. The current study discovered a favorable association between employees' perceptions of organizational politics and social stressors including workplace exclusion which encouraged CWB and employee intentions to quit. Therefore, organizational management must choose strategies to lessen the tendency of political activities among employees in order to prevent these undesirable behavioral attitudinal results. Furthermore, Human resource managers should make vigilant efforts to determine an employee's hostile attribution style during the initial selection process for reducing the cost of future rehiring.

5.7 Limitations of the study

Though the current study has made efforts to eliminate all the problems, there are still certain limitations that must be avoided in the future for gaining satisfactory results.

Firstly, the data collection was done through a cross sectional design due time constraints and non-availability of resources to conduct a time lagged design. In a cross-sectional survey, information was gathered from the respondents at a particular time which means that all respondents were requested to fill the survey on the time and day mentioned. Moreover, the sample size was moderate and might not represent all the population of private sector Pakistan including employees' who have issues with political environment or workplace ostracism. Since the sample size was not large and because a more comprehensive sample size might influence the results, the sample size together with the data collection method serves as the limitation of the current study.

Secondly, due to time and resource limitations, convenience sampling was employed as the data sampling technique for the current study. The current study was interested to include employees of the HR department working in various organizations in the sample population to get a more generalized result, thus the researcher used personal resources to reach the employees of certain departments. Respondents are selected for convenience sampling based on their availability to the researcher. The use of a convenience sample proposes a limitation for the study.

Thirdly, the study focused on just private sector organizations for data collection, with the focus of two cities only. It might affect the strength of the study as other cities might make a more comprehensive sample of the entire population. As working conditions and organizational culture are different in the private and public sector, excluding the public sector from the sample together with the choice of cities proposes a limitation for the current study.

5.8 Future Directions

Study limitations suggest that more research is needed for conducting future research on the area of employees' political perceptions in organization.

In the current study, quantitative research design was used by employing a survey method for data collection. Likert scales of five and seven points were used as suggested by the authors of previous related studies. Both respondents and researchers find the Likert scale to be quite useful when expressing their opinions and analyzing data. However, through in-depth interviews which is one of the feature of qualitative approach, respondents can express their opinions more comprehensively. Employee perceptions of the political work environment may be examined using qualitative techniques including interviews, direct observations, focus group discussions, or a combination of these. It is suggested for the future studies to use qualitative or mixed methodologies to analyze the structural model developed in the study for more in-depth analysis.

The study's theoretical framework was created with respondents from a developing country and the findings have a number of useful applications across other developing countries. Future studies that look into employees' perspectives in different contexts may include respondents from other emerging nations to present a more holistic picture of developing countries facing organizational politics and workplace ostracism resulting in numerous negative employee outcomes. It can better explain other missing dimensions of the perceptual political climate by comparing such studies with the research samples on developed countries.

The current study has used one particular department and different organizations from the services sector. Although various organizations bring good generalizability of the results, still other excluded sectors might potentially propose different results on the basis of different

organizational cultures. Future surveys and research might include other economic sectors, with a view to have diversified findings and improved generalizability.

Lastly, according to a thorough evaluation of the literature, some other study variables are essential enough to be examined in the same model to gain a better understanding. Negative reciprocity beliefs are important in this regard, which can be tested as moderator together with hostile attribution bias in this relationship between workplace ostracism and employee negative outcomes. Moreover, the combined effect of hostile attribution bias and negative reciprocity beliefs might be able to define the conditional indirect effects in more detail. Likewise, other social stressors such as workplace incivility and workplace bullying might be tested as mediators in relationship between POP and employee turnover intention and CWB to further the literature on POP affecting employee outcomes through interpersonal stressors.

5.9 Conclusion

The purpose of the present study was to investigate the relationship between employee perceptions of organizational politics and employee workplace outcomes that are counterproductive behaviors and turnover intention. It also investigated the unexplored mediating role of workplace ostracism between employee political perception, counterproductive behaviors of employee and turnover intention. Working in a politicized work environment will enhance antisocial behaviors and result in negative workplace outcomes. Further, the moderating role of hostile attribution bias was investigated between the direct relationship of workplace ostracism and employee outcomes and the indirect relationship between employee perceptions of organizational politics and employee outcomes. The current study is conducted to represent the employees working in the private work setting of Pakistan, having political perceptions negatively effecting positive relationships at work resulting in exacerbating negative workplace

outcomes. The results of the study showed that workplace ostracism partially mediates the positive relationship between POP and employee outcomes. The results also showed that hostile attribution bias did not moderate the relationship of workplace ostracism and turnover intention but provided support for intervention for workplace ostracism and CWB.

The findings further revealed similar results for conditional indirect effect of POP on employee outcomes. The study found that employees having high hostile attribution bias perceive their work environment as political even when the reality is different and assume being ostracized leading to increase in maladaptive behaviors in the form of retaliation. However, moderating roles was not significant for high increased turnover intentions as predicted by POP and workplace ostracism.

Therefore, it is concluded that individual differences play a crucial role in determining employee perceptions and workplace outcomes.

REFERENCES

- Adams, S. H., & John, O. P. (1997). A hostility scale for the California Psychological Inventory: MMPI, observer Q-sort, and big-five correlates. *Journal of Personality Assessment*, 69(2), 408–424. https://doi.org/10.1207/s15327752jpa6902_11
- Albana, M. J., & Yeşiltaş, M. (2021). Impact of linguistic ostracism on knowledge sharing, hiding and hoarding and the moderating role of cultural intelligence. *Kybernetes*, 51(3), 1180–1198. <https://doi.org/10.1108/K-12-2020-0906>
- Ali, A., Zhang, Z., & Aman, N. (2021). Game of Organizational Politics Leading to Turnover Intention. *Journal of Advanced Research in Economics and Administrative Sciences*, 2(2), 35-49. <https://doi.org/10.47631/jareas.v2i2.223>
- Anderson, J. W. (2009). Organizational shunning: The disciplinary functions of “non-sense.” *Atlantic Journal of Communication*, 17(1), 36–50.
- Asrar-ul-Haq, M., Ali, H. Y., Anwar, S., Iqbal, A., Iqbal, M. B., Suleman, N., Haris-ul-Mahasbi, M. (2019). Impact of organizational politics on employee work outcomes in higher education institutions of Pakistan: Moderating role of social capital. *South Asian Journal of Business Studies*.
- Azeem, M. U., Bajwa, S. U., Shahzad, K., & Aslam, H. (2020). Psychological contract violation and turnover intention: The role of job dissatisfaction and work disengagement. *Employee Relations: The International Journal*, 42(6), 1291–1308. <https://doi.org/10.1108/ER-09-2019-0372>

- Bai, Y., Han, G. H., & Harms, P. D. (2016). Team Conflict Mediates the Effects of Organizational Politics on Employee Performance: A Cross-Level Analysis in China. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 139(1), 95–109. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-015-2604-6>
- Bajwa, E., Yousaf, M., & Rizwan, M. (2014). Employee Turnover Intention in services sector of Pakistan. *International Journal of Human Resource Studies*, 4, 164. <https://doi.org/10.5296/ijhrs.v4i2.5905>
- Bedi, A. (2021). No Herd for Black Sheep: A Meta-Analytic Review of the Predictors and Outcomes of Workplace Ostracism. *Applied Psychology*, 70(2), 861–904. <https://doi.org/10.1111/apps.12238>
- Bell, E., Harley, B., & Bryman, A. (2015). *Business research methods*. Oxford university press.
- Bennett, R., & Robinson, S. (2000). Development of a Measure of Workplace Deviance. *The Journal of Applied Psychology*, 85, 349–360. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.85.3.349>
- Bigliardi, B., Petroni, A., & Ivo Dormio, A. (2005). Organizational socialization, career aspirations and turnover intentions among design engineers. *Leadership & Organization Development Journal*, 26(6), 424–441. <https://doi.org/10.1108/01437730510617645>
- Blackhart, G. C., Nelson, B. C., Knowles, M. L., & Baumeister, R. F. (2009). Rejection elicits emotional reactions but neither causes immediate distress nor lowers self-esteem: A meta-analytic review of 192 studies on social exclusion. *Personality and Social Psychology Review*, 13(4), 269–309.
- Blau, P. M. (1964). *1964 Exchange and power in social life*. New York: Wiley.
- Buchanan, D. A. (2008). You stab my back, I'll stab yours: Management experience and perceptions of organization political behaviour. *British Journal of Management*, 19(1), 49–64.

- Burns, T. (1961). Micropolitics: Mechanisms of Institutional Change. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 6(3), 257–281. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2390703>
- Büyükyılmaz, O., & BiÇer, C. (2019). The effect of perceptions of organizational politics on workplace friendship: a study on healthcare employees. *International Journal of Management Economics and Business*, 15(2) <https://doi.org/10.17130/ijmeb.2019252108>
- Byrne, B. M. (2013). *Structural equation modeling with Mplus: Basic concepts, applications, and programming*. routledge.
- Carmeli, A., & Weisberg, J. (2006). Exploring turnover intentions among three professional groups of employees. *Human Resource Development International*, 9(2), 191–206. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13678860600616305>
- Chabrol, H., Van Leeuwen, N., Rodgers, R., & Séjourné, N. (2009). Contributions of psychopathic, narcissistic, Machiavellian, and sadistic personality traits to juvenile delinquency. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 47(7), 734–739.
- Chang, C., Rosen, C. C., & Levy, P. E. (2009). The Relationship between Perceptions of Organizational Politics and Employee Attitudes, Strain, and Behavior: A Meta-Analytic Examination. *The Academy of Management Journal*, 52(4), 779–801.
- Chang, C.-H., Rosen, C. C., Siemienieć, G. M., & Johnson, R. E. (2012). Perceptions of Organizational Politics and Employee Citizenship Behaviors: Conscientiousness and Self-monitoring as Moderators. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 27(4), 395–406. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10869-012-9257-6>
- Chen, P. Y., & Spector, P. E. (1992). Relationships of work stressors with aggression, withdrawal, theft and substance use: An exploratory study. *Journal of Occupational and Organizational Psychology*, 65(3), 177–184.

- Chen, R., & Song, J. (2019). Effect of workplace ostracism on counterproductive work behavior—Psychological contract breach as the mediator. *UTCC International Journal of Business & Economics*, 11(2), 3–23.
- Chen, Y., & Li, S. (2019). The relationship between workplace ostracism and sleep quality: A mediated moderation model. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 10, 319.
- Chen, Y., & Li, S. (2020). Relationship Between Workplace Ostracism and Unsafe Behaviors: The Mediating Effect of Psychological Detachment and Emotional Exhaustion. *Psychological Reports*, 123(2), 488–516. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0033294118813892>
- Cheng, J. L. (1983). Organizational context and upward influence: An experimental study of the use of power tactics. *Group & Organization Studies*, 8(3), 337–355.
- Chin, W. W. (2010). *How to write up and report PLS analyses*. In 'Handbook of Partial Least Squares'. (Eds VV Esposito, WW Chin, J Henseler and H Wang) pp. 655–690. Springer: Heidelberg, Berlin.
- Chin, W. W., Marcolin, B. L., & Newsted, P. R. (2003). A partial least squares latent variable modeling approach for measuring interaction effects: Results from a Monte Carlo simulation study and an electronic-mail emotion/adoption study. *Information Systems Research*, 14(2), 189–217.
- Chinomona, E., & Mofokeng, T. M. (2016). Impact Of Organisational Politics On Job Dissatisfaction And Turnover Intention: An Application Of Social Exchange Theory On Employees Working In Zimbabwean Small And Medium Enterprises (SMEs). *Journal of Applied Business Research (JABR)*, 32(3), 857–870. <https://doi.org/10.19030/jabr.v32i3.9661>

- Cho, H.-T., & Yang, J.-S. (2018). How perceptions of organizational politics influence self-determined motivation: The mediating role of work mood. *Asia Pacific Management Review*, 23(1), 60–69.
- Choi, Y. (2019). The moderating effect of leader member exchange on the relationship between workplace ostracism and psychological distress. *Asia-Pacific Journal of Business Administration*, 11(2), 146–158. <https://doi.org/10.1108/APJBA-11-2018-0205>
- Chung, Y. W. (2017). The role of person–organization fit and perceived organizational support in the relationship between workplace ostracism and behavioral outcomes. *Australian Journal of Management*, 42(2), 328–349. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0312896215611190>
- Chung, Y. W., & Yang, J. Y. (2017). The mediating effects of organization-based self-esteem for the relationship between workplace ostracism and workplace behaviors. *Baltic Journal of Management*, 12(2), 255–270. <https://doi.org/10.1108/BJM-06-2016-0130>
- Clercq, D. D., Khan, M. A., & Haq, I. U. (2021). Perceived organizational politics and turnover intentions: Critical roles of social adaptive behavior and emotional regulation skills. *Journal of Management & Organization*, 1–19. <https://doi.org/10.1017/jmo.2021.26>
- Cohen, A. (2016). Are they among us? A conceptual framework of the relationship between the dark triad personality and counterproductive work behaviors (CWBs). *Human Resource Management Review*, 26(1), 69–85.
- Cohen, A., & Diamant, A. (2019). The role of justice perceptions in determining counterproductive work behaviors. *The International Journal of Human Resource Management*, 30(20), 2901–2924.
- Cohen, J. (1988). Statistical power analysis for the behavioral sciences. Lawrence Erlbaum Associates. Hillsdale, NJ, 20–26.

- Colarelli, S. M. (1984). Methods of communication and mediating processes in realistic job previews. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 69(4), 633–642. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.69.4.633>
- Conlon, D. E., Meyer, C. J., & Nowakowski, J. M. (2005). How Does Organizational Justice Affect Performance, Withdrawal, and Counterproductive Behavior? In *Handbook of organizational justice* (pp. 301–327). Mahwah, NJ, US: Lawrence Erlbaum Associates Publishers.
- Crawford, W. S., Lamarre, E., Kacmar, K. M., & Harris, K. J. (2019). Organizational Politics and Deviance: Exploring the Role of Political Skill. *Human Performance*, 32(2), 92–106. <https://doi.org/10.1080/08959285.2019.1597100>
- Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2017). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches*. Sage publications.
- Cropanzano, R., Anthony, E. L., Daniels, S. R., & Hall, A. V. (2017). Social exchange theory: A critical review with theoretical remedies. *Academy of Management Annals*, 11(1), 479–516.
- Cropanzano, R., Byrne, Z. S., Bobocel, D. R., & Rupp, D. E. (2001). Moral virtues, fairness heuristics, social entities, and other denizens of organizational justice. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 58(2), 164–209.
- Cropanzano, R., & Mitchell, M. S. (2005). Social exchange theory: An interdisciplinary review. *Journal of Management*, 31(6), 874–900.
- Cullen, K. L., Fan, J., & Liu, C. (2014). Employee Popularity Mediates the Relationship Between Political Skill and Workplace Interpersonal Mistreatment. *Journal of Management*, 40(6), 1760–1778. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206311435104>

- Dalal, R. S. (2005). A meta-analysis of the relationship between organizational citizenship behavior and counterproductive work behavior. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 90(6), 1241.
- De Clercq, D., Haq, I. U., & Azeem, M. U. (2018). The roles of informational unfairness and political climate in the relationship between dispositional envy and job performance in Pakistani organizations. *Journal of Business Research*, 82, 117–126. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2017.09.006>
- Delle, E. (2013). The influence of perception of organizational politics on employee job involvement and turnover intentions: Empirical evidence from Ghanaian organizations. *European Journal of Business and Management*, 5(9), 151–160.
- Dess, G. G., & Shaw, J. D. (2001). Voluntary turnover, social capital, and organizational performance. *Academy of Management Review*, 26(3), 446–456.
- Dodge, K. A., & Coie, J. D. (1987). Social-information-processing factors in reactive and proactive aggression in children's peer groups. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 53(6), 1146.
- Dodge, K. A., Malone, P. S., Lansford, J. E., Sorbring, E., Skinner, A. T., Tapanya, S., ... Al-Hassan, S. M. (2015). Hostile attributional bias and aggressive behavior in global context. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 112(30), 9310–9315.
- Douglas, S. C., & Martinko, M. J. (2001). Exploring the role of individual differences in the prediction of workplace aggression. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 86(4), 547.
- Drory, A., & Vigoda-Gadot, E. (2010). Organizational politics and human resource management: A typology and the Israeli experience. *Human Resource Management Review*, 20(3), 194–202.

- Dunlop, P. D., & Lee, K. (2004). Workplace deviance, organizational citizenship behavior, and business unit performance: The bad apples do spoil the whole barrel. *Journal of Organizational Behavior: The International Journal of Industrial, Occupational and Organizational Psychology and Behavior*, 25(1), 67–80.
- Emerson, R. M. (1976). Social exchange theory. *Annual Review of Sociology*, 2, 335–362.
<https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.so.02.080176.002003>
- Farasat, M., Afzal, U., Jabeen, S., Farhan, M., & Sattar, A. (2021). Impact of Workplace Ostracism on Turnover Intention: An Empirical Study from Pakistan. *The Journal of Asian Finance, Economics and Business*, 8(11), 265–276.
<https://doi.org/10.13106/jafeb.2021.vol8.no11.0265>
- Fatima, A. (2016). Impact of workplace ostracism on counter productive work behaviors: Mediating role of job satisfaction. *Abasyn Journal of Social Sciences*, 9(2), 388–408.
- Fedor, D. B., & Maslyn, J. M. (2002). Politics and political behavior: Where else do we go from here? In F. J. Yammarino & F. Dansereau (Eds.), *The many faces of multi-level issues* (pp. 271–285). Emerald Group Publishing Limited. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S1475-9144\(02\)01036-6](https://doi.org/10.1016/S1475-9144(02)01036-6)
- Ferris, D. L., Berry, J., Brown, D. J., & Lian, H. (2008). When silence isn't golden: measuring ostracism in the workplace. *Academy of Management Proceedings*, 2008(1), 1–6. Academy of Management Briarcliff Manor, NY 10510.
- Ferris, D. L., Brown, D. J., Berry, J. W., & Lian, H. (2008). The development and validation of the Workplace Ostracism Scale. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 93(6), 1348–1366.
<https://doi.org/10.1037/a0012743>

- Ferris, D. L., Lian, H., Brown, D. J., & Morrison, R. (2015). Ostracism, self-esteem, and job performance: When do we self-verify and when do we self-enhance? *Academy of Management Journal*, 58(1), 279–297.
- Ferris, G., Adams, G., Kolodinsky, R., Hochwarter, W., & Ammeter, A. (2002). Perceptions of organizational politics: Theory and research directions. *Research in Multi Level Issues*, 1, 179–254. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S1475-9144\(02\)01034-2](https://doi.org/10.1016/S1475-9144(02)01034-2)
- Ferris, G. R., & Kacmar, K. M. (1992). Perceptions of organizational politics. *Journal of Management*, 18(1), 93–116.
- Firth, R. (1967). Themes in economic anthropology: A general comment. *Themes in Economic Anthropology*, 6, 1–28.
- Fiset, J., Al Hajj, R., & Vongas, J. G. (2017). Workplace ostracism seen through the lens of power. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 8, 1528.
- Foa, U. G., & Foa, E. B. (1974). *Societal structures of the mind*. Charles C Thomas.
- Forsyth, D. R., Banks, G. C., & McDaniel, M. A. (2012). A meta-analysis of the Dark Triad and work behavior: A social exchange perspective. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 97(3), 557.
- Gotsis, G., & Kortezi, Z. (2011). Bounded self-interest: A basis for constructive organizational politics. *Management Research Review*, 34(4), 450–476.
- Gouldner, A. W. (1960). The norm of reciprocity: A preliminary statement. *American Sociological Review*, 161–178.
- Gruys, M. L., & Sackett, P. R. (2003). Investigating the dimensionality of counterproductive work behavior. *International Journal of Selection and Assessment*, 11(1), 30–42.

- Haider, S., Fatima, N., & de Pablos-Heredero, C. (2020). A three-wave longitudinal study of moderated mediation between perceptions of politics and employee turnover intentions: The role of job anxiety and political skills. *Journal of Work and Organizational Psychology*.
- Hair Jr, Joe F., Matthews, L. M., Matthews, R. L., & Sarstedt, M. (2017). PLS-SEM or CB-SEM: updated guidelines on which method to use. *International Journal of Multivariate Data Analysis*, 1(2), 107–123.
- Hair Jr, Joseph F., Hult, G. T. M., Ringle, C. M., & Sarstedt, M. (2016). *A primer on partial least squares structural equation modeling (PLS-SEM)*. Sage publications.
- Hansen-Brown, A. A., & Freis, S. D. (2021). Assuming the worst: Hostile attribution bias in vulnerable narcissists. *Self and Identity*, 20(2), 152–164.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/15298868.2019.1609574>
- Harvey, P., Harris, K. J., & Martinko, M. J. (2008). The Mediated Influence of Hostile Attributional Style on Turnover Intentions. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 22(4), 333–343. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10869-008-9073-1>
- Hayward, D., Bungay, V., Wolff, A. C., & MacDonald, V. (2016). A qualitative study of experienced nurses' voluntary turnover: Learning from their perspectives. *Journal of Clinical Nursing*, 25(9–10), 1336–1345. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jocn.13210>
- Heaphy, E. D., & Dutton, J. E. (2008). Positive social interactions and the human body at work: Linking organizations and physiology. *Academy of Management Review*, 33(1), 137–162.
- Henseler, J., Ringle, C. M., & Sarstedt, M. (2015). A new criterion for assessing discriminant validity in variance-based structural equation modeling. *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, 43(1), 115–135.

- Henseler, J., Ringle, C. M., & Sinkovics, R. R. (2009). The use of partial least squares path modeling in international marketing. In *New challenges to international marketing*. Emerald Group Publishing Limited.
- Hitlan, R. T., Clifton, R. J., & DeSoto, M. C. (2006). Perceived exclusion in the workplace: The moderating effects of gender on work-related attitudes and psychological health. *North American Journal of Psychology*, 8(2), 217–236.
- Hochwarter, W. A., Rosen, C. C., Jordan, S. L., Ferris, G. R., Ejaz, A., & Maher, L. P. (2020). Perceptions of Organizational Politics Research: Past, Present, and Future. *Journal of Management*, 46(6), 879–907. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206319898506>
- Homans, G. C. (1958). Social behavior as exchange. *American Journal of Sociology*, 63(6), 597–606.
- Hoobler, J. M., & Brass, D. J. (2006). Abusive supervision and family undermining as displaced aggression. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 91(5), 1125.
- Howard, M. C., Cogswell, J. E., & Smith, M. B. (2019). The antecedents and outcomes of workplace ostracism: A meta-analysis. *The Journal of Applied Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1037/apl0000453>
- Hung, T.-K., Chi, N.-W., & Lu, W.-L. (2009). Exploring the relationships between perceived coworker loafing and counterproductive work behaviors: The mediating role of a revenge motive. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 24(3), 257–270.
- Iqbal, I. (2021). Impact of Organizational Politics on Organization Success, Job Satisfaction and Turnover Intentions with Moderating Effect of Individual Values. *Journal of Workplace Behavior*, 2(1), 46–68.

- Jahanzeb, S., & Fatima, T. (2018). How Workplace Ostracism Influences Interpersonal Deviance: The Mediating Role of Defensive Silence and Emotional Exhaustion. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 33(6), 779–791. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10869-017-9525-6>
- Judge, T. A., Scott, B. A., & Ilies, R. (2006). Hostility, job attitudes, and workplace deviance: Test of a multilevel model. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 91(1), 126.
- Kacmar, K. M., & Carlson, D. S. (1997). Further validation of the perceptions of politics scale (POPS): A multiple sample investigation. *Journal of Management*, 23(5), 627–658.
- Kacmar, K. M., & Ferris, G. R. (1991). Perceptions of Organizational Politics Scale (POPS): Development and Construct Validation. *Educational and Psychological Measurement*, 51(1), 193–205. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0013164491511019>
- Kaplan, H. B. (1975). *Self-attitudes and deviant behavior*. Goodyear.
- Karim, D. (2021). Relationship between perceived organisational politics and workplace ostracism at higher education institutions. *International Journal of Management in Education*, 15, 318. <https://doi.org/10.1504/IJMIE.2021.116529>
- Karim, D. N., Abdul Majid, A. H., Omar, K., & Aburumman, O. J. (2021). The mediating effect of interpersonal distrust on the relationship between perceived organizational politics and workplace ostracism in higher education institutions. *Heliyon*, 7(6), e07280. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2021.e07280>
- Kaur, N., & Kang, L. S. (2022). Perception of organizational politics, knowledge hiding and organizational citizenship behavior: The moderating effect of political skill. *Personnel Review*, ahead-of-print(ahead-of-print). <https://doi.org/10.1108/PR-08-2020-0607>
- Khan, N. A., Khan, A. N., & Gul, S. (2019). Relationship between perception of organizational politics and organizational citizenship behavior: Testing a moderated mediation model.

- Asian Business & Management*, 18(2), 122–141. <https://doi.org/10.1057/s41291-018-00057-9>
- Kim, H., & Qu, H. (2020). The mediating roles of gratitude and obligation to link employees' social exchange relationships and prosocial behavior. *International Journal of Contemporary Hospitality Management*.
- Kipnis, D., Schmidt, S. M., & Wilkinson, I. (1980). Intraorganizational influence tactics: Explorations in getting one's way. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 65(4), 440.
- Klein Tuernte, S., Bogaerts, S., & Veling, W. (2019). Hostile attribution bias and aggression in adults—A systematic review. *Aggression and Violent Behavior*, 46, 66–81. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.avb.2019.01.009>
- Kock, N., & Lynn, G. (2012). Lateral collinearity and misleading results in variance-based SEM: An illustration and recommendations. *Journal of the Association for Information Systems*, 13(7).
- Kokkinos, C. M., Karagianni, K., & Voulgaridou, I. (2017). Relational aggression, big five and hostile attribution bias in adolescents. *Journal of Applied Developmental Psychology*, 52, 101–113.
- Kolodinsky, R. W., Treadway, D. C., & Ferris, G. R. (2007). Political skill and influence effectiveness: Testing portions of an expanded Ferris and Judge (1991) model. *Human Relations*, 60(12), 1747–1777.
- Kong, M. (2018). Effect of Perceived Negative Workplace Gossip on Employees' Behaviors. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 9. Retrieved from <https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/fpsyg.2018.01112>

- Landells, E. M., & Albrecht, S. L. (2017). The Positives and Negatives of Organizational Politics: A Qualitative Study. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 32(1), 41–58. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10869-015-9434-5>
- Law, H., & Falkenbach, D. M. (2018). Hostile Attribution Bias as a Mediator of the Relationships of Psychopathy and Narcissism With Aggression. *International Journal of Offender Therapy and Comparative Criminology*, 62(11), 3355–3371. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0306624X17742614>
- Lazarus, R. S., & Folkman, S. (1984). *Stress, appraisal, and coping*. Springer publishing company.
- Li, M., Xu, X., & Kwan, H. K. (2021). Consequences of Workplace Ostracism: A Meta-Analytic Review. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 12. Retrieved from <https://www.frontiersin.org/article/10.3389/fpsyg.2021.641302>
- Makhdoom, I. F., Mehmood, B., & Atta, M. (2017). Mediating role of job burnout for the relationship of perceived organizational politics and counterproductive work behaviors among school teachers. *Journal of Behavioural Sciences*, 27(2), 149–164.
- Malik, O. F., Shahzad, A., Raziq, M. M., Khan, M. M., Yusaf, S., & Khan, A. (2019). Perceptions of organizational politics, knowledge hiding, and employee creativity: The moderating role of professional commitment. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 142, 232–237.
- Mao, Y., Liu, Y., Jiang, C., & Zhang, I. D. (2018). Why am I ostracized and how would I react?—A review of workplace ostracism research. *Asia Pacific Journal of Management*, 35(3), 745–767.

- Matthews, B. A., & Norris, F. H. (2002). When is believing “seeing”? Hostile attribution bias as a function of self-reported aggression 1. *Journal of Applied Social Psychology*, 32(1), 1–31.
- Meisler, G., Drory, A., & Vigoda-Gadot, E. (2019). Perceived organizational politics and counterproductive work behavior: The mediating role of hostility. *Personnel Review*, 49(8), 1505–1517. <https://doi.org/10.1108/PR-12-2017-0392>
- Milich, R., & Dodge, K. A. (1984). Social information processing in child psychiatric populations. *Journal of Abnormal Child Psychology*, 12(3), 471–489.
- Miller, B., Rutherford, M., & Kolodinsky, R. (2008). Perceptions of Organizational Politics: A Meta-analysis of Outcomes. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 22, 209–222. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10869-008-9061-5>
- Mobley, W. H. (1977). Intermediate linkages in the relationship between job satisfaction and employee turnover. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 62(2).
- Moon, C., & Lee, S. (2021). Narcissism and Anger: The Moderating Role of Social Exclusion and the Mediating Role of Hostile Attribution Bias Mechanism. *Studies in Humanities and Social Sciences*, 64(1), 53–72.
- Myers, M. D. (2019). *Qualitative research in business and management*. Sage.
- Ngo-Henha, P. E. (2018). A Review of Existing Turnover Intention Theories. *International Journal of Economics and Management Engineering*, 11(11), 2760–2767.
- Ogunbamila, B. (2013). Perception of organizational politics and job-related negative emotions as predictors of workplace incivility among employees of distressed banks. *European Scientific Journal*, 9(5).

- Oh, I.-S., Guay, R. P., Kim, K., Harold, C. M., Lee, J.-H., Heo, C.-G., & Shin, K.-H. (2014). Fit Happens Globally: A Meta-Analytic Comparison of the Relationships of Person–Environment Fit Dimensions with Work Attitudes and Performance Across East Asia, Europe, and North America. *Personnel Psychology*, 67(1), 99–152. <https://doi.org/10.1111/peps.12026>
- Peng, A. C., & Zeng, W. (2017). Workplace ostracism and deviant and helping behaviors: The moderating role of 360 degree feedback. *Journal of Organizational Behavior*, 38(6), 833–855.
- Pfeffer, J. (1992). Understanding power in organizations. *California Management Review*, 34(2), 29–50.
- Price, J. L. (2001). Reflections on the determinants of voluntary turnover. *International Journal of Manpower*.
- Qi, L., Cai, D., Liu, B., & Feng, T. (2020). Effect of workplace ostracism on emotional exhaustion and unethical behaviour among Chinese nurses: A time-lagged three-wave survey. *Journal of Advanced Nursing*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jan.14405>
- Robinson, S. L., O'Reilly, J., & Wang, W. (2013). Invisible at Work: An Integrated Model of Workplace Ostracism. *Journal of Management*, 39(1), 203–231. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206312466141>
- Rockwood, N. J., & Hayes, A. F. (2017). MLmed: An SPSS macro for multilevel mediation and conditional process analysis. *Poster Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Association of Psychological Science (APS), Boston, MA.*
- Rosen, C. C., & Hochwarter, W. A. (2014). Looking back and falling further behind: The moderating role of rumination on the relationship between organizational politics and

- employee attitudes, well-being, and performance. *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes*, 124(2), 177–189. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.obhdp.2014.03.003>
- Rosen, C. C., & Levy, P. E. (2013). Stresses, swaps, and skill: An investigation of the psychological dynamics that relate work politics to employee performance. *Human Performance*, 26(1), 44–65.
- Sakurai, K., & Jex, S. M. (2012). Coworker incivility and incivility targets' work effort and counterproductive work behaviors: The moderating role of supervisor social support. *Journal of Occupational Health Psychology*, 17(2), 150.
- Saleem, H. (2015). The impact of leadership styles on job satisfaction and mediating role of perceived organizational politics. *Procedia-Social and Behavioral Sciences*, 172, 563–569.
- Sharma, N., & Dhar, R. L. (2021). From curse to cure of workplace ostracism: A systematic review and future research agenda. *Human Resource Management Review*, 100836.
- Shaw, J. D., Gupta, N., & Delery, J. E. (2005). Alternative Conceptualizations of the Relationship Between Voluntary Turnover and Organizational Performance. *Academy of Management Journal*, 48(1), 50–68. <https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2005.15993112>
- Singh, L. B., & Srivastava, S. (2021). Linking workplace ostracism to turnover intention: A moderated mediation approach. *Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management*, 46, 244–256. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jhtm.2020.12.012>
- Sousa-Poza, A., & Henneberger, F. (2004). Analyzing Job Mobility with Job Turnover Intentions: An International Comparative Study. *Journal of Economic Issues*, 38(1), 113–137. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00213624.2004.11506667>

- Spain, S. M., Harms, P., & LeBreton, J. M. (2014). The dark side of personality at work. *Journal of Organizational Behavior*, 35(S1), S41–S60. <https://doi.org/10.1002/job.1894>
- Sun, Y., & Xia, H. (2018). Research on Perceptions of Organizational Politics and Its Influence on Employee Silence. *Open Journal of Business and Management*, 6(2), 250–264. <https://doi.org/10.4236/ojbm.2018.62018>
- Tenenhaus, M., Amato, S., & Esposito Vinzi, V. (2004). A global goodness-of-fit index for PLS structural equation modelling. *Proceedings of the XLII SIS Scientific Meeting*, 1(2), 739–742.
- Tett, R. P., & Meyer, J. P. (1993). Job satisfaction, organizational commitment, turnover intention, and turnover: Path analyses based on meta-analytic findings. *Personnel Psychology*, 46(2), 259–293.
- Triandis, H. C. (1996). The psychological measurement of cultural syndromes. *American Psychologist*, 51(4), 407–415. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066X.51.4.407>
- Ullah, S., Hasnain, S. A., Khalid, A., & Aslam, A. (2019). Effects of Perception of Organizational Politics on Employee's Well-Being: The Mediating Role of Trust and Interpersonal Conflicts. *European Online Journal of Natural and Social Sciences: Proceedings*, 8(1(s)), 1–14.
- Vigoda, E. (2002). Stress-related aftermaths to workplace politics: The relationships among politics, job distress, and aggressive behavior in organizations. *Journal of Organizational Behavior*, 23(5), 571–591. <https://doi.org/10.1002/job.160>
- Vui-Yee, K., & Yen-Hwa, T. (2020). When does ostracism lead to turnover intention? The moderated mediation model of job stress and job autonomy. *IIMB Management Review*, 32(3), 238–248. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.iimb.2019.10.007>

- Wamba, S. F., Gunasekaran, A., Akter, S., Ren, S. J., Dubey, R., & Childe, S. J. (2017). Big data analytics and firm performance: Effects of dynamic capabilities. *Journal of Business Research*, 70, 356–365.
- Williams, K. D. (1997). Social Ostracism. In R. M. Kowalski (Ed.), *Aversive Interpersonal Behaviors* (pp. 133–170). Boston, MA: Springer US. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4757-9354-3_7
- Williams, K. D. (2002). *Ostracism: The Power of Silence*. Guilford Press.
- Williams, K. D. (2007). Ostracism. *Annual Review of Psychology*, 58(1), 425–452. <https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.psych.58.110405.085641>
- Williams, K. D. (2009). Chapter 6 Ostracism: A Temporal Need-Threat Model. In *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology* (Vol. 41, pp. 275–314). Academic Press. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0065-2601\(08\)00406-1](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0065-2601(08)00406-1)
- Williams, L. J., & Hazer, J. T. (1986). Antecedents and consequences of satisfaction and commitment in turnover models: A reanalysis using latent variable structural equation methods. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 71(2), 219.
- Witt, L. A., & Spector, P. E. (2012). Personality and reactions to organizational politics. In *Politics in Organizations* (pp. 589–622). Routledge.
- Wright, T. A., & Bonett, D. G. (2007). Job Satisfaction and Psychological Well-Being as Nonadditive Predictors of Workplace Turnover. *Journal of Management*, 33(2), 141–160. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206306297582>
- Wu, L.-Z., Yim, F. H., Kwan, H. K., & Zhang, X. (2012). Coping with workplace ostracism: The roles of ingratiation and political skill in employee psychological distress. *Journal of Management Studies*, 49(1), 178–199.

- Wu, L.-Z., Zhang, H., Chiu, R. K., Kwan, H. K., & He, X. (2014). Hostile Attribution Bias and Negative Reciprocity Beliefs Exacerbate Incivility's Effects on Interpersonal Deviance. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 120(2), 189–199. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-013-1658-6>
- Xiong, R., & Wen, Y. (2020). Employees' turnover intention and behavioral outcomes: The role of work engagement. *Social Behavior and Personality: An International Journal*, 48(1), 1–7. <https://doi.org/10.2224/sbp.8609>
- Xu, X., Kwan, H. K., & Li, M. (2020). Experiencing workplace ostracism with loss of engagement. *Journal of Managerial Psychology*, 35(7/8), 617–630. <https://doi.org/10.1108/JMP-03-2020-0144>
- Yan, Y., Zhou, E., Long, L., & Ji, Y. (2014). The Influence of Workplace Ostracism on Counterproductive Work Behavior: The Mediating Effect of State Self-Control. *Social Behavior and Personality: An International Journal*, 42. <https://doi.org/10.2224/sbp.2014.42.6.881>
- Yang, J., & Treadway, D. C. (2018). A Social Influence Interpretation of Workplace Ostracism and Counterproductive Work Behavior. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 148(4), 879–891. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-015-2912-x>
- Zettler, I., & Hilbig, B. E. (2010). Honesty–Humility and a Person–Situation Interaction at Work. *European Journal of Personality*, 24(7), 569–582. <https://doi.org/10.1002/per.757>
- Zhang, R., Ye, C., & Ferreira-Meyers, K. (2017). Linking workplace ostracism to interpersonal citizenship behavior: A moderated mediation model of work-to-family conflict and rumination. *International Journal of Stress Management*, 24(3), 293–320. <https://doi.org/10.1037/str0000056>

- Zhang, X., & Dai, L. (2015). The relationship between neuroticism and experience of workplace ostracism in new employees. *Open Journal of Social Sciences*, 3(02), 80.
- Zhao, H., Xia, Q., He, P., Sheard, G., & Wan, P. (2016). Workplace ostracism and knowledge hiding in service organizations. *International Journal of Hospitality Management*, 59, 84–94. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijhm.2016.09.009>

APPENDIX A



RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE



QUAID-I-AZAM UNIVERSITY, ISLAMABAD SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT SCIENCES

Dear Participant,

I am a researcher in the field of Management Sciences; my area of specialization is Human Resource Management. As a part of my MPhil thesis, I am conducting research on employees' perceptions of organizational politics and its impact on their job related attitudinal and behavioral outcomes.

I will be grateful if you help me by filling out the following questionnaire. I assure you that your responses will be kept confidential and will only be used for educational purposes. I appreciate your responses that best reflect your experiences in your job. Your responses will be valuable for my research. I thank you in advance for your time and cooperation.

Yours truly,

Hafiza Huma Tariq
Quaid-i- Azam School of Management Sciences,
Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad.

SECTION-1

Demographic Information

1. Gender

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female

2. Age Group (years)

- ☐ 18-25
- ☐ 26-35
- ☐ 36-45
- ☐ 46-50
- ☐ 50-Above

3. Experience (years)

- ☐ 0-5
- ☐ 6-10
- ☐ 11-15
- ☐ 16-20
- ☐ 21-25
- ☐ 25-Above

4. Income

- ☐ less than Rs.15,000
- ☐ Rs.35,000 to Rs. 49,000
- ☐ Rs.50,000 to Rs. 74,000
- ☐ Rs.75,000 to Rs. 99,000
- ☐ 100,000 and Above

SECTION-2

- ❖ **How often according to the following statements others treated you in a certain way in your organization? (1 = Never, 2 = Once in a while, 3= Sometimes, 4 = Fairly often, 5 = Often, 6 = Constantly, 7 = Always)**

Others ignored you at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Others left the area when you entered.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
My greetings have gone unanswered at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I involuntarily sat alone in a crowded lunchroom at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Others avoided me at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I noticed others would not look at me at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Others at work shut me out of the conversation.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Others refused to talk to me at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Others at work treated me as if I weren't there.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Others at work did not invite me or ask me if I wanted anything when they went out for a coffee break.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

- ❖ **According to the following statements how often you behaved in a certain way at your workplace? (1= never, 2= once a year, 3= twice a year, 4=several times a year, 5= monthly, 6= weekly, 7= daily)**

Taken property from work without permission.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Spent too much time fantasizing or daydreaming instead of working.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Falsified a receipt to get reimbursed for more money than you spent on business expenses.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Taken an additional or longer break than is acceptable at your workplace.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Come in late to work without permission.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Littered your work environment.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Neglected to follow your boss's instructions.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Intentionally worked slower than you could have worked.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Discussed confidential company information with an unauthorized person.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Used an illegal drug or consumed alcohol on the job.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Put little effort into your work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Dragged out work in order to get overtime.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Made fun of someone at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Said something hurtful to someone at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Made an ethnic, religious, or racial remark at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Cursed at someone at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Played a mean prank on someone at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Acted rudely toward someone at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Publicly embarrassed someone at work.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

- ❖ **To what extent do you agree/disagree with the following statements regarding how decisions are made in your organization? (1 = strongly disagree, 2 = disagree, 3 = neutral, 4 = agree, 5 = strongly agree)**

Favoritism not merit gets people ahead.	1	2	3	4	5
People build themselves up by tearing others down.	1	2	3	4	5
Some groups always get their way.	1	2	3	4	5
There are influential groups no one crosses.	1	2	3	4	5
Policy changes help only a few.	1	2	3	4	5
People don't speak up for fear of retaliation.	1	2	3	4	5
Promotions go to top performers.	1	2	3	4	5
Rewards come to hard workers.	1	2	3	4	5
People are encouraged to speak out.	1	2	3	4	5
There is no place for Yes men.	1	2	3	4	5
Pay and promotion policies are not politically applied.	1	2	3	4	5
Pay and promotion decisions are consistent with policies.	1	2	3	4	5

- ❖ **To what extent do you agree/disagree that the following statements regarding yourself are true? (1 = strongly disagree, 2 = disagree, 3 = neutral, 4 = agree, 5 = strongly agree)**

If I have my own way, I will be working for this organization one year from now.	1	2	3	4	5
I frequently think of quitting my job.	1	2	3	4	5
I am planning to search for a new job during the next 12 months.	1	2	3	4	5

- ❖ **To what extent do you agree/disagree that the following statements regarding your opinions about others are true? (1 = strongly disagree, 2 = disagree, 3 = neutral, 4 = agree, 5 = strongly agree)**

I commonly wonder what hidden reason another person may have for doing something nice for me.	1	2	3	4	5
Most people are honest chiefly through fear of being caught.	1	2	3	4	5
I think most people would lie to get ahead.	1	2	3	4	5
Most people make friends because friends are likely to be useful to them.	1	2	3	4	5
People pretend to care more about one another than they really do.	1	2	3	4	5
A person is better off if he/she doesn't trust anyone.	1	2	3	4	5

Dear Participant, Thank you for your valuable responses.

APPENDIX B

Cross Loadings

	CWB	HAB	POP	TI	WO
CWB1	0.798	0.464	0.527	0.376	0.570
CWB10	0.826	0.433	0.526	0.379	0.563
CWB11	0.780	0.514	0.544	0.403	0.551
CWB12	0.840	0.500	0.600	0.434	0.618
CWB13	0.797	0.468	0.544	0.437	0.589
CWB14	0.847	0.514	0.583	0.444	0.590
CWB15	0.833	0.450	0.551	0.392	0.578
CWB16	0.832	0.492	0.540	0.368	0.576
CWB17	0.854	0.497	0.568	0.391	0.604
CWB18	0.831	0.489	0.586	0.402	0.572
CWB19	0.808	0.457	0.536	0.388	0.599
CWB2	0.764	0.431	0.494	0.345	0.526
CWB3	0.821	0.495	0.513	0.344	0.532
CWB4	0.784	0.478	0.516	0.379	0.511
CWB5	0.816	0.450	0.526	0.381	0.551
CWB6	0.823	0.447	0.544	0.375	0.596
CWB7	0.826	0.522	0.546	0.396	0.588
CWB8	0.809	0.451	0.560	0.397	0.607
CWB9	0.815	0.449	0.530	0.341	0.546
HAB1	0.518	0.793	0.426	0.474	0.366
HAB2	0.447	0.790	0.416	0.481	0.370
HAB3	0.402	0.745	0.441	0.477	0.363
HAB4	0.444	0.788	0.483	0.525	0.418
HAB5	0.441	0.780	0.471	0.552	0.342
HAB6	0.410	0.689	0.351	0.401	0.311
POP1	0.561	0.471	0.840	0.608	0.623
POP10	0.606	0.520	0.847	0.603	0.641
POP11	0.561	0.413	0.810	0.600	0.592
POP12	0.562	0.491	0.838	0.628	0.664
POP2	0.568	0.455	0.850	0.581	0.648
POP3	0.557	0.507	0.851	0.643	0.654
POP4	0.553	0.506	0.854	0.596	0.615
POP5	0.535	0.511	0.836	0.619	0.648
POP6	0.489	0.443	0.812	0.553	0.561
POP7	0.542	0.421	0.798	0.569	0.642
POP8	0.579	0.470	0.835	0.629	0.670
POP9	0.531	0.429	0.796	0.569	0.599
TI1	0.395	0.572	0.625	0.881	0.519

TI2	0.440	0.533	0.663	0.869	0.550
TI3	0.423	0.576	0.621	0.892	0.547
WO1	0.560	0.381	0.635	0.535	0.826
WO10	0.562	0.366	0.595	0.438	0.804
WO2	0.631	0.450	0.673	0.578	0.885
WO3	0.626	0.415	0.666	0.585	0.860
WO4	0.600	0.415	0.643	0.515	0.860
WO5	0.592	0.426	0.654	0.507	0.823
WO6	0.604	0.384	0.662	0.515	0.851
WO7	0.568	0.348	0.617	0.488	0.842
WO8	0.599	0.408	0.640	0.515	0.866
WO9	0.586	0.402	0.627	0.481	0.838

Note: Bold values present highest item loaded in its own construct, POP=perception of politics, WO=workplace ostracism, CWB=counterwork productive behavior, TI=turnover intention, HAB=hostile attribution bias